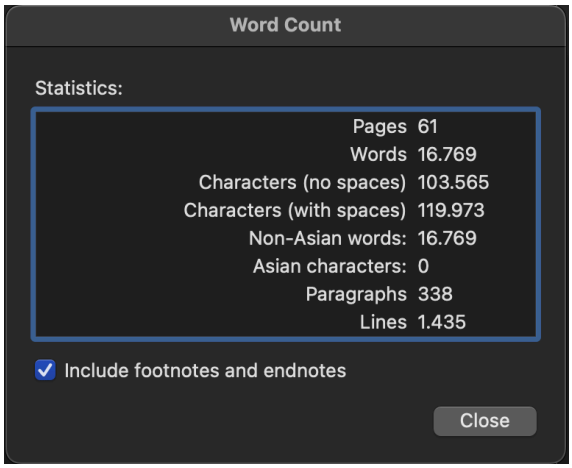
Market Entry Strategy for Chinese Consumer Electronics in Denmark

Lean startup leveraging innovation diffusion and blue ocean strategy

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Written by **TRIPLE HELIX**:

Sovar Alexia Maria

Sokolowski Thomas

YE Fangfei

SHEN Zhenyang

TRIPLE HELIX

Abstract

This project investigates how Nine United can systematically identify, evaluate, and introduce emerging Chinese consumer-electronics products into the Nordic market, with a focus on Denmark. China has become a global leader in consumer electronics innovation, offering rapidly developed and market-ready products across categories such as smart home devices, wearables, and AI-driven gadgets. However, successful market entry requires careful adaptation to Nordic consumer values, habits, regulatory standards, and trust expectations. The study applies Rogers' Diffusion of Innovations theory to assess products based on relative advantage, compatibility, complexity, trialability, and observability, targeting early adopters and the early majority. It also draws on The Lean Startup methodology, emphasizing Minimum Viable Products, Build–Measure–Learn cycles, and innovation accounting to test and refine product offerings in a low-risk, iterative manner. Additionally, Blue Ocean Strategy guides the identification of uncontested market spaces and value innovation opportunities. The findings indicate that combining structured innovation scouting, consumer insight, and iterative experimentation enables Nine United to select promising Chinese electronics, tailor them to Nordic preferences, and introduce them effectively through suitable channels, supporting sustainable growth and competitive advantage in new market segments.

Keywords

Consumer electronics, China, Nordic market, Market entry, Innovation diffusion, Early adopters, Relative advantage, Compatibility, Complexity, Trialability, Observability, Lean Startup, Minimum Viable Product, Blue Ocean Strategy, Value innovation, Market growth, Product adoption, Consumer behavior.

Executive summary

Introduction

The Chinese consumer electronics sector is evolving rapidly, offering opportunities and challenges for international firms like Nine United, a Danish company known for design, branding, and trading expertise. Early identification of emerging innovations can give Nine United a competitive advantage in Nordic markets, but products that succeed in China may fail abroad due to cultural, regulatory, and consumer differences.

This project aims to help Nine United systematically scout and evaluate Chinese innovations for their potential in Nordic markets. By combining insights on Chinese product trends with Danish consumer preferences, the study seeks to bridge the gap between innovation availability and market adoption.

Leveraging its dual presence in China and Denmark, Nine United can integrate sourcing, branding, and local market knowledge to select products most likely to succeed. With China emerging as a global hub for smart home devices, health-tech, mobility gadgets, and AI-driven products, this project provides a framework to capitalize on innovation while ensuring commercial and cultural fit.

Objectives / Goals

The primary objective of this project is to provide Nine United with a structured, evidence-based approach to identifying and evaluating emerging Chinese consumer-electronics products with strong potential in Nordic markets. The project aims to:

1. **Systematically identify emerging innovations** in the Chinese consumer electronics sector, including new product categories, technological trends, and innovative brands.
2. **Assess market potential** by analyzing Danish consumer preferences, adoption patterns, buying channels, and after-sales expectations.
3. **Apply innovation management frameworks** such as innovation diffusion theory, user-driven innovation, absorptive capacity, and market adaptation to support structured scouting and selection processes.
4. **Recommend potential products and strategies** for introducing them into the Danish and Nordic markets, including identifying suitable distribution channels and adaptation requirements.
5. **Provide actionable insights** that bridge the gap between Chinese innovation and Nordic market demand, ensuring that selected products are culturally, commercially, and operationally viable.

By achieving these objectives, the project seeks to equip Nine United with a practical, theoretically grounded methodology for leveraging Chinese consumer-electronics innovations to strengthen its Nordic operations and competitive positioning.

Methodology

This study uses a pragmatic research approach, combining theory and real-world insights to support Nine United's product scouting decisions. An abductive approach guided iterative learning between existing literature on innovation diffusion, consumer behavior, and cross-market adaptation, and empirical data from Danish consumers. A mixed methods design integrated qualitative and quantitative research to ensure both depth and breadth of insights.

The research followed a three-stage, sequential design:

1. Product Screening: Five emerging Chinese consumer electronics products in health, convenience, home living, and smart technologies were identified through secondary research and trend analysis.
2. Focus Groups: A qualitative study with five Danish participants evaluated the products' relevance, usability, and fit with local consumer habits. This narrowed the selection to three products: a UV toothbrush sanitizer, a handheld garment steamer, and a hydroponic indoor garden.
3. Survey: A larger quantitative survey of Danish residents aged 18–44 validated the focus group findings, measuring interest, perceived usefulness, adoption barriers, and preferred purchasing channels.

This sequential methodology ensured that recommendations were evidence-based, reflecting both consumer preferences and market potential, providing a robust foundation for selecting products with strong commercial prospects in Denmark.

Findings / Results

The findings show that Danish consumers are open to new consumer electronics but place strong emphasis on practical value, trust, and lifestyle compatibility. Products that are simple, intuitive, and address everyday needs are viewed more positively than complex or novelty-driven solutions. Key barriers to adoption include concerns about quality, reliability, lack of reviews, and unfamiliar brands.

Among the evaluated products, the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer demonstrated the strongest commercial potential due to its clear hygiene benefits, ease of use, and strong alignment with daily routines. The Handheld Electric Steamer showed moderate appeal, particularly as a travel and convenience product. The Hydroponic Indoor Garden generated limited interest, with adoption constrained by space requirements, maintenance effort, and perceived complexity, but could have the highest yield if positioned as design product, rather than a gardening product.

Recommendations / Implications

Nine United should prioritize products that deliver clear functional benefits, require minimal behavioral change, and align with Danish values related to quality and trust. The UV Toothbrush Sterilizer is recommended as the primary product for market entry, supported by strong branding and clear communication of hygiene benefits. The Handheld Electric Steamer may serve as a secondary, niche product when positioned around convenience and mobility. The Hydroponic Indoor Garden is not recommended for broad market rollout due to limited scalability and high adoption barriers.

Overall, integrating consumer insights early in the innovation scouting process can reduce market risk and improve cross-market product selection.

The study confirms that a structured, evidence based scouting approach enables Nine United to reduce market risk and improve product selection. By combining innovation theory with consumer insights, the project identifies the UV toothbrush steriliser as the most viable product for market entry, while highlighting the limitations of more complex or lifestyle-dependent innovations.

Overall, the findings underline the importance of early consumer validation, clear value communication, and consistency between product quality, pricing, and brand positioning when transferring innovations from China to Nordic markets.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Problem area

For Danish firms like Nine United whose strengths lie in design, lifestyle brands, and strong trading portfolio this presents both an opportunity and challenges, as an opportunity there is scouting of emerging Chinese electronics innovations early, and bring these products or technologies into nordic markets before competitors, leveraging their existing design, branding and distribution capabilities.
The challenges that arise from scouting products in China which can be used in nordic markets, are due to the technological innovations not automatically being translated across cultural, regulatory, and consumer preference boundaries. Therefore, many Chinese products can succeed domestically but fail to resonate with other markets due to:

- different value perceptions
- different adoption patterns
- different design expectations
- different trust and privacy norms
- different regulatory standards (ESG regulation & GDPR)

1.2 Purpose of the study

The problem this project addresses is the growing need for Nine United to be able to systematically identify and assess emerging Chinese electronic innovations that they can successfully diffuse into the Nordic markets. As China is now seen as a leading hub for rapid consumer electronics innovation (Mckinsey Global institute, 2019), The possibility for foreign companies to take advantage of this is not guaranteed with the challenges mentioned above. Therefore, it is important to not only be able to spot technological innovations that work in the Chinese market, but to also understand whether these products can resonate differently across markets and how they fit the Nordic markets.

1.3 Scope of the study

This project will examine how innovation management frameworks, such as innovation diffusion theory, user driven innovation, absorptive capacity and market adaptation can support a structured approach to innovation scouting for Nine United. The purpose is to develop insights into which types of Chinese consumer electronics hold potential for success in the Nordic markets and to produce evidence-based recommendations grounded in theory, primary research and systematic market analysis**.**

1.4 Problem formulation

How can Nine United approach the identification and evaluation of emerging Chinese consumer-electronics products with commercial potential in the Danish market, considering differences in consumer behavior, innovation adoption, and market conditions between China and Denmark?

Sub-Questions

1. How do Danish consumers generally perceive and adopt new consumer-electronics products, and which factors most strongly influence their willingness to adopt innovations?

2. What characterizes the current Chinese consumer-electronics innovation landscape, and how do emerging product trends and innovation dynamics create opportunities and risks for entry into the Danish market?

3. How can insights from both the Danish demand side and the Chinese supply side be combined to guide the selection and market positioning of Chinese consumer-electronics products in Denmark?

1.5 Company context

In China, Nine United's roots trace back to BESTSELLER's entry into the Chinese market with Bestseller Fashion Group China, which now operates over 6,500 branded chain and concept stores, leading the mid-market apparel sector. MTHP A/S was established with buying offices in China to

support retail branding, supplying customized products to BESTSELLER and other brands. The sourcing network in China forms a vital part of Nine United's supply chain, retail branding, and trading activities, enabling them to deliver a wide range of goods effectively across Asia. (Nine United, n.d)

In Denmark and Scandinavia, Nine United's history began in 1975 with its founding in the Danish town of Ringkøbing within BESTSELLER. Denmark remains a central hub, with offices like STUDIO 9 providing retail branding solutions close to the clients. The company also manages prominent properties such as the Lindencrone Mansion in Copenhagen, which hosts reputable events like Copenhagen Fashion Week. Danish leadership influences the company's vision and values, focusing on trust, collaboration, cultural diversity, and quality. (Nine United, n.d)

Thus, Nine United connects its Danish/Scandinavian heritage anchored in values and design excellence with its Chinese operations that drive sourcing and retail business growth, fostering a unified yet diversified corporate identity and strategy.

Nine United is structured as a privately held family of international companies operating within several key business areas such as retail branding, supply & trading and properties

In summary, the group's structure integrates design and retail branding, supply chain and trading, and property management, supported by a geographically diverse presence with hubs in Asia (including China) and Europe (including Denmark/Scandinavia). (Nine United, n.d)

1.6 Industry and market context

In the last decade, China has moved from copycat manufacturing to becoming a global frontrunner in consumer electronics innovation, particularly within smart home devices, health-tech, mobility gadgets, and AI-driven consumer products. These technologies evolve rapidly and often reach commercial maturity in China before comparable products arrive in Western markets. (Grand View Research, n.d.)

Chinese consumer electronics ecosystem

China's consumer electronics sector stands out globally today because it combines large scale manufacturing capacity, deep supply chain integration, a political push (People's Republic of China, State

Council, 2021) and a massive domestic market which demands constant innovation. This combination enables the country to develop, refine and scale their consumer electronic products faster than many other regions.

Market size and growth

China represents one of the largest consumer electronics markets globally. Market research estimates indicate that the sector generated approximately USD 214 billion in revenue in 2024 and is projected to reach around USD 347 billion by 2030, representing a compound annual growth rate of more than 8 percent (Grand View Research, 2024). This growth is supported not only by mature product categories such as smartphones, televisions, and personal computers, but also by expanding segments such as smart home devices, wearables, and connected appliances (EY, 2024).

The sustained growth reflects both rising disposable income and a strong cultural appetite for technological upgrades. As a result, domestic firms continuously invest in research, design, and product differentiation, strengthening the overall innovation ecosystem (EY, 2024).

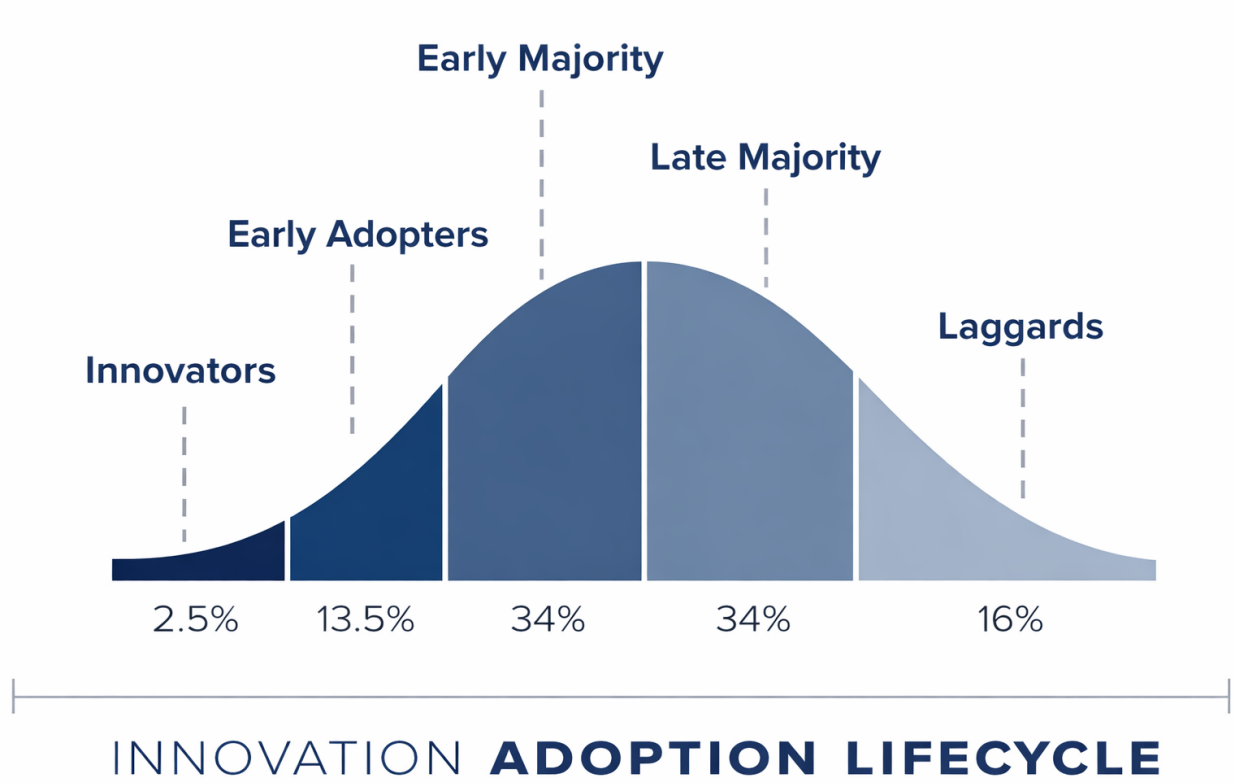
1.7 Innovation diffusion theory

In this project, innovation diffusion is about how Nine United can help new Chinese consumer electronics successfully enter the Nordic market from the Chinese market, and how to make sure Nordic consumers actually adopt and trust these products (Rogers, 2003; Gefen, Karahanna, & Straub, 2003).

Chinese electronics often become advanced and market ready faster than similar products in Europe. This creates a strong opportunity, but also the main challenge: even if a product works perfectly in China or Asia, it will not automatically fit Nordic consumer habits, values, and expectations (Steenkamp & Hofstede, 2002). The diffusion strategy will then focus less on technical performance of the product and more on how to introduce and explain it to give Nordic consumers a positive experience (Moore, 2014).

A key part of the strategy is to start with the right target group. The focus has been on primarily younger, tech-interested consumers who live in Denmark. We have been aiming to target people who are either innovators, early adopters, or part of the early majority in the innovation adoption lifecycle (Rogers, 2003; Moore, 2014), as these groups are more open to trying new brands and technologies. These

consumers have been reached through online channels, social platforms, and networking. If these groups accept the products and show interest in using them themselves, it creates credibility for the wider market (Gefen et al., 2003; Moore, 2014).



To further support the diffusion strategy, Rogers' (2003) Diffusion of Innovations theory can be applied as a structured framework for evaluating which Chinese consumer-electronics products are most suitable for introduction into the Danish market. Rogers identifies five key innovation attributes that influence adoption speed and success: relative advantage, compatibility, complexity, trialability, and observability. These attributes are especially relevant when assessing products that are technologically mature in China but new to Nordic consumers.

Relative advantage refers to the extent to which a product is perceived as better than existing alternatives. For Nine United, this means identifying Chinese electronics that offer clear consumer benefits, such as improved functionality, better price–performance ratios, or unique features not currently available in the Danish market. Products without a clearly communicated advantage are less likely to gain early traction.

Compatibility concerns how well the product fits Danish consumer values, habits, and expectations. Even advanced products may face resistance if they conflict with Nordic preferences related to simplicity, sustainability, data privacy, or reliability. Ensuring compatibility may therefore require adjustments in product positioning, branding, or user experience rather than changes to the core technology.

Complexity describes how easy the product is to understand and use. Products perceived as complicated or requiring significant behavioral change can slow down adoption, particularly beyond the early adopter segment. For this reason, clear communication, intuitive design, and localized instructions play a critical role in reducing perceived complexity.

Trialability refers to the degree to which consumers can experiment with a product before fully committing to it. This attribute directly influences distribution-channel decisions. Online platforms with flexible return policies, demonstrations, or temporary test periods can reduce perceived risk and encourage adoption among early adopters and the early majority.

Observability relates to how visible the benefits of the product are to others. Products that can be easily shared, reviewed, or demonstrated—especially through social media and online communities—are more likely to spread through peer influence. This is particularly relevant for younger, tech-interested Danish consumers, where social validation plays an important role in adoption decisions.

1.8 The Lean Startup (Nine United's New venture)

Nine United is looking to expand its business by entering the consumer electronics market, marking a shift from its traditional focus on furniture, lighting, and clothing. The company plans to build on its strong trading network in China and its established market position in the Nordics to support this expansion. While this move represents a clear strategic departure, it also creates significant opportunities for growth. To manage this transition in a structured and low-risk way, Nine United can draw inspiration from the principles outlined in *The Lean Startup* by Eric Ries (2011).

One of the book's core concepts is the Build–Measure–Learn cycle, which encourages companies to test new ideas on a small scale before committing major resources. For Nine United, this could mean starting with a selected range of electronic products that align with the company's existing strengths in design, quality, and sourcing. Rather than launching a full product portfolio immediately, the company can begin with a Minimum Viable Product (MVP), such as a limited assortment of consumer gadgets or accessories introduced through online channels or selected retail partners. By doing this it allows the company to

observe how customers respond to the Chinese products in the Nordic market. By tracking indicators such as customer interest, purchase behavior, perceived product quality, and pricing effectiveness, Nine United can gather data about market demand and the competitive landscape in the Nordics. This reduces the risk of overinvesting in inventory before the concept has been properly validated.

The Lean Startup also emphasizes continuous learning and adaptation. If early tests reveal that customers prefer different features or respond better to alternative pricing, these adjustments can be made quickly and at a relatively low cost. This makes the expansion more flexible and cost-efficient over time. Another concept is innovation accounting, where progress is measured not only through financial results but through validated learning. This involves defining clear assumptions, testing them in real market conditions, and making decisions based on evidence rather than intuition.

By realizing and working with the intention of the project as being seen as a new venture, Nine United can explore the electronics market in a structured and realistic manner. The company can build knowledge gradually, minimize unnecessary risks, and move forward only when there is strong confidence in the direction. Over time, this increases the likelihood that the electronics business will become a stable and profitable part of the company's overall portfolio.

Going forward, this project will treat scouting as a core part of Nine United's new venture development. As a result, the written work will place a strong emphasis on strategies and theories derived from *The Lean Startup* (Ries, 2011).

1.9 Blue ocean strategy

This project will use the theory of Blue Ocean Strategy to guide Nine United in identifying opportunities to create uncontested market space in Denmark (Kim & Mauborgne, 2015). Rather than competing directly with established consumer-electronics brands, the strategy focuses on finding gaps in the market where new Chinese innovations can meet unmet consumer needs. By combining cutting-edge Chinese technology with Nordic consumer preferences, Nine United can develop unique value propositions that appeal to early adopters and early majority consumers. The approach emphasizes value innovation, which simultaneously increases consumer benefits while reducing unnecessary costs, helping to differentiate products and reduce competitive pressure. Applying this strategy supports both the product selection process and the design of marketing and distribution approaches that align with Danish consumer expectations.

2. Literature review

2.1 Danish consumer context: purchasing power, values, and behaviour

Understanding Danish consumer behaviour and economic conditions is essential when assessing the diffusion potential of emerging consumer electronics products in the Danish market. Denmark represents a mature, high-income consumer economy characterised by strong purchasing power, high institutional trust, and value-driven consumption patterns. These structural conditions shape how new products are evaluated and adopted, particularly when they originate from non-European markets and involve new technologies.

Purchasing power and disposable income

Denmark consistently ranks among the countries with the highest disposable income per capita within the European Union and the OECD. According to the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), Danish households benefit from relatively high net-adjusted disposable income levels, supported by stable employment, comprehensive welfare systems, and comparatively low-income inequality (OECD, 2023). Statistics Denmark reports that the average personal income in Denmark was around 414,900 DKK in 2024, indicating a relatively high level of earnings before tax, which supports household capacity for discretionary spending when adjusted for taxes and consumption needs (Statistics Denmark, 2025). Eurostat data further confirm that Denmark is among the top EU countries in terms of household purchasing power standards, indicating strong capacity for discretionary spending beyond necessities (Eurostat, 2023).

High purchasing power does not necessarily imply impulsive or price-insensitive consumption. Research on consumer behavior in high-income economies suggests that consumers tend to place greater emphasis on perceived value, long-term utility, and quality when making purchasing decisions (Hansen, 2019). In the Danish context, this implies that consumers may be willing to pay a premium for consumer electronics if these products are perceived as reliable, durable, and genuinely beneficial, while remaining selective toward products that appear unnecessary, poorly differentiated, or insufficiently substantiated.

Value orientation: quality, functionality, and longevity

A defining characteristic of Danish consumer behavior is a strong orientation toward quality, functionality, and longevity. Studies on Nordic consumption patterns highlight a preference for products that deliver practical benefits and integrate seamlessly into everyday life, rather than products driven primarily by novelty or technological complexity (Magnusson et al., 2017). This functionalist orientation is closely linked to Scandinavian design traditions, which emphasize simplicity, usability, and understated aesthetics.

From an innovation diffusion perspective, this implies that Danish consumers are less likely to adopt consumer electronics perceived as gimmicky or overly complex, even when the underlying technology is advanced. Innovations are more likely to succeed when they clearly address an existing problem, simplify routines, or enhance everyday efficiency. Consequently, perceived usefulness plays a central role in shaping adoption decisions (Rogers, 2003).

Sustainability as a consumption norm

Sustainability plays a central role in Danish consumer culture, but its influence on purchasing behaviour is nuanced. Denmark consistently ranks high on environmental awareness and pro-environmental attitudes, and sustainability considerations are deeply embedded in public discourse and policy frameworks (European Commission, 2022). However, empirical research indicates that sustainability increasingly functions as a baseline expectation rather than a decisive differentiator in purchasing decisions (Thøgersen, 2021).

For many Danish consumers, products marketed as sustainable are expected to also perform well in terms of convenience, quality, and price. When sustainable products are perceived as inconvenient, complex, or offering limited functional benefits, adoption remains unlikely despite positive environmental attitudes. This reflects the well-documented attitude–behavior gap in sustainable consumption, whereby favorable intentions do not necessarily translate into actual behavior (Carrington et al., 2014).

Trust, regulation, and risk perception

Trust plays a particularly important role in Danish consumer decision-making. Denmark is characterized by high levels of institutional trust, including trust in public authorities and regulatory bodies (OECD, 2022). While this generally facilitates market transactions, it also leads to heightened expectations regarding product safety, regulatory compliance, and transparency.

For consumer electronics, especially those related to health, hygiene, or food, Danish consumers tend to exhibit strong sensitivity to regulatory standards, certifications, and credible documentation. Research suggests that in high-trust societies, consumers may be more cautious toward products that lack clear regulatory validation or originate from unfamiliar production contexts (Siegrist et al., 2020). This is particularly relevant for products imported from non-EU markets, where perceived differences in regulatory regimes and quality control may influence risk perception.

Purchasing behavior and channels

Danish consumers are highly digitally literate and routinely engage in extensive information search prior to purchase. Online channels play a central role in product discovery and comparison, while physical retail remains important for reassurance, particularly for higher-involvement products (Statistics Denmark, 2023). Omnichannel purchasing behavior is therefore common, with consumers expecting consistency between online information, customer reviews, and offline purchasing experiences.

In addition, Danish consumers place strong emphasis on after-sales service, transparent return policies, and clear warranty conditions. These expectations reflect a broader cultural emphasis on consumer rights and reinforce the importance of trust and reliability in shaping adoption decisions for new consumer electronics.

Implications for innovation diffusion

Taken together, the Danish consumer context presents both opportunities and constraints for the diffusion of emerging consumer electronics. High purchasing power and strong interest in quality, sustainability, and functionality create favorable conditions for well-designed and credible innovations. At the same time, selective adoption behavior, strong regulatory expectations, and sensitivity to perceived risk mean that technological novelty alone is insufficient to guarantee market success. These characteristics provide a critical contextual foundation for analyzing the market gaps associated with specific consumer electronics product categories.

2.2 Cross-market innovation diffusion challenges (China to Denmark)

While China has emerged as a global hub for rapid consumer electronics innovation, successful diffusion of these innovations into the Danish market is far from guaranteed. Innovation diffusion research consistently demonstrates that technological success in one market does not automatically translate into adoption in another, particularly when products cross cultural, institutional, and regulatory boundaries (Rogers, 2003). For firms such as Nine United that aim to scout emerging Chinese consumer electronics for potential introduction into Denmark, understanding these cross-market diffusion challenges is therefore critical.

Differences in innovation ecosystems and market logics

China's consumer electronics innovation ecosystem is characterized by large-scale manufacturing capabilities, rapid iteration cycles, and intense domestic competition, supported by a massive consumer base and strong state-led industrial strategies (State Council of the People's Republic of China, 2021). These conditions enable firms to test, refine, and scale new product categories quickly, often prioritizing speed to market and functional novelty.

In contrast, the Danish market operates within a smaller, highly regulated, and institutionally mature innovation system. Research on national innovation systems highlights that such environments tend to favor incremental innovation, reliability, and compliance over rapid experimentation (Lundvall, 2016). As a result, products developed for the Chinese market may encounter difficulties when introduced into Denmark if they do not align with local expectations regarding quality assurance, documentation, and long-term value.

Cultural and behavioral differences in technology adoption

Cross-cultural studies of technology adoption show that consumer perceptions of usefulness, risk, and value are shaped by cultural norms and social contexts (Straub et al., 1997). While Chinese consumers are often characterized as early adopters of new consumer electronics and smart home technologies, Danish consumers typically exhibit more cautious adoption patterns, particularly for products that affect health, food, or personal data (Hofstede et al., 2010).

In high-trust but risk-aware societies such as Denmark, consumers may be slower to adopt unfamiliar technologies until their benefits are clearly demonstrated and socially validated. Research on diffusion processes suggests that in such contexts, observability, trialability, and credible endorsements play a greater role in shaping adoption decisions than novelty or technological sophistication alone (Rogers, 2003).

Country-of-origin effects and perceived product legitimacy

Country-of-origin effects represent a significant barrier in cross-market diffusion, especially for technologically complex or health-adjacent products. Empirical research consistently finds that consumers use country-of-origin cues as heuristics for evaluating product quality, safety, and reliability when direct evaluation is difficult (Magnusson et al., 2017). Products originating from countries perceived as having different regulatory standards or quality control regimes may therefore face additional skepticism in the Danish market.

This effect is particularly relevant for Chinese consumer electronics. While China is increasingly recognized as an innovation leader, lingering perceptions related to mass production, variable quality, and limited transparency continue to influence consumer trust in some Western markets (Li et al., 2021). As a result, even technologically advanced products may struggle to gain acceptance unless firms actively mitigate country-of-origin concerns through branding, certification, and transparent communication.

Regulatory and institutional constraints

Regulatory alignment constitutes another major challenge in the diffusion of Chinese consumer electronics into Denmark. Products introduced into the Danish market must comply with a range of European Union regulations, including CE marking requirements, product safety directives, environmental standards, and, in some cases, data protection regulations such as the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) (European Commission, 2023).

Research on international market entry highlights that regulatory distance increases the costs and complexity of product adaptation, particularly for small and mid-sized firms (Kostova & Zaheer, 1999). Products designed for the Chinese domestic market may require substantial redesign, documentation, or certification to meet EU standards, which can alter cost structures and delay market entry. Failure to address these requirements early in the innovation scouting process can therefore undermine the commercial viability of otherwise promising products.

Implications for innovation scouting and selection

Taken together, these factors indicate that cross-market diffusion from China to Denmark involves more than identifying technologically advanced or fast-growing product categories. Differences in innovation ecosystems, consumer adoption behavior, country-of-origin perceptions, and regulatory environments create systematic barriers that must be accounted for when evaluating market potential.

For firms such as Nine United, this underscores the importance of a structured innovation scouting approach that integrates insights into Danish consumer behavior with an understanding of Chinese supply-side dynamics. Rather than focusing solely on technological novelty or domestic success in China, effective product selection requires assessing the degree to which emerging consumer electronics can be adapted to meet Danish expectations regarding trust, regulation, and everyday usability. This perspective provides a necessary bridge between the general market context and the product-specific market gaps analyzed in subsequent sections.

2.3 Market gap 1: Hygiene and health electronics (UV sterilizers)

Health and hygiene have gained increased importance in consumer electronics following the COVID-19 pandemic. In China, UV-based household sterilizers have achieved rapid diffusion, while adoption in Denmark remains limited. A clear market gap exists between heightened hygiene awareness and consumers' willingness to adopt unfamiliar health-related electronic devices.

Research indicates that increased hygiene awareness can raise openness toward preventive solutions, particularly when they support existing routines (Sheth, 2020). However, higher awareness alone does not guarantee adoption. Consumers may remain skeptical when products are perceived as unnecessary or lacking clear scientific validation (Betsch et al., 2020).

From a technical perspective, studies confirm that UV-C radiation can reduce microorganisms under controlled conditions (Boylan et al., 2008). At the same time, research highlights that consumer-grade UV devices vary significantly in effectiveness due to differences in design, exposure time, and shielding (Rutala & Weber, 2013). This creates uncertainty for consumers, particularly in markets where verified performance is expected.

Safety concerns further constrain adoption. UV-C radiation can be harmful if devices are poorly designed, and EU authorities emphasize the need for strict safety controls and clear documentation (SCHEER,

2018). In Denmark, where institutional trust is high, consumers also expect strong regulatory compliance and credible certification for health-related products (Siegrist et al., 2020).

Overall, the market gap is driven less by lack of hygiene interest and more by concerns related to trust, safety, and legitimacy. For products such as UV toothbrush sterilizers, adoption depends heavily on transparent communication, regulatory compliance, and credible validation of effectiveness.

2.4 Market gap 2: Indoor food-growing technologies (hydroponic gardens)

Indoor hydroponic gardening systems combine sustainability, wellness, and smart home living, and have gained traction in markets such as China. In Denmark, however, diffusion remains limited. A market gap exists between positive sustainability attitudes and willingness to adopt technologically complex home food-growing systems.

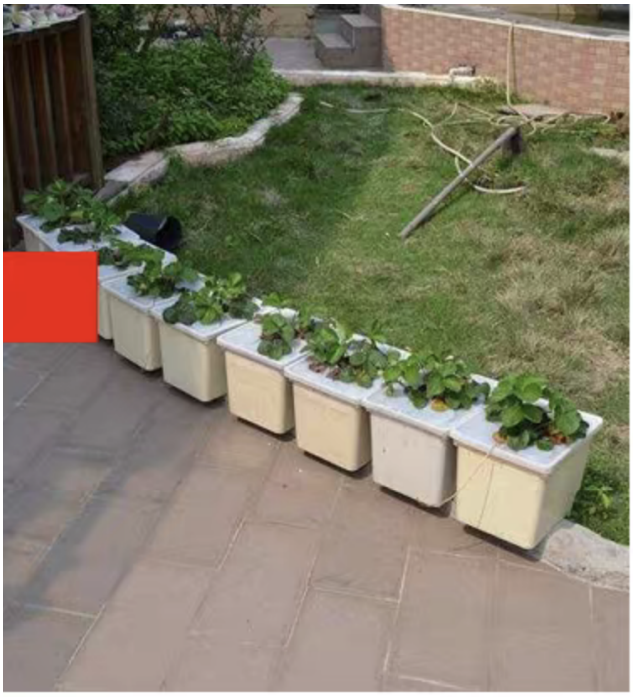
Danish consumers generally support environmental sustainability and local food production (European Commission, 2022). Nevertheless, research shows that positive sustainability attitudes do not automatically translate into adoption of new technologies (Thøgersen, 2021). This is particularly relevant for food-related technologies, which are closely linked to habits and perceptions of naturalness.

Studies on consumer perceptions of hydroponic systems show mixed acceptance. While some consumers view them as innovative, others perceive them as unnatural or overly technological (Siegrist et al., 2018). Limited familiarity with the technology may further lead to doubts regarding nutritional quality or safety (Bearth et al., 2014).

Practical barriers also play a significant role. Indoor hydroponic systems often require ongoing maintenance and energy-intensive lighting, which may conflict with consumers' desire for low-effort solutions and raise concerns about electricity use (Magnusson et al., 2017).

The market gap therefore lies between abstract sustainability ideals and the practical realities of everyday use. Successful diffusion depends not only on environmental benefits, but also on ease of use, transparency, and perceived naturalness.

Hydroponic gardens are truly fascinating, as hydroponics has not only blossomed into a thriving global commercial industry but also seen a sharp growth in household applications. The Netherlands leads the commercial sector, with 13,000 hectares of high-tech greenhouses equipped with 80% automation and rainwater recycling systems, growing tomatoes, cucumbers and cut flowers that account for half of the nation's fruit and vegetable value and are exported worldwide. Other key players include the United States, which boasts large-scale leafy green hydroponic farms in California and Arizona; Israel, a pioneer in growing specialty crops via hydroponics in arid regions; Singapore, home to urban pesticide-free vegetable hydroponic parks; and China, whose hydroponics market is projected to hit $30 billion by 2025. This sustainable farming method uses 90% less water than traditional agriculture, driving the global commercial hydroponics market to an expected $25.1 billion by 2027.













On the household front, compact hydroponic systems have surged in popularity, with smart modular kits featuring LED grow lights and smartphone app monitoring making it easy for urban dwellers to grow herbs and leafy greens in limited spaces. These systems also double as stylish indoor decorative greenery, catering to the growing demand for healthy homegrown food and aesthetic living.



2.5 Market gap 3: Convenience technologies for garment care (steamers)

Handheld electric steamers have diffused rapidly in markets such as China, driven by compact living conditions and mobile lifestyles. In Denmark, adoption has been slower despite increasing time pressure and mobility. This reflects a market gap between modern, flexible lifestyles and traditional garment-care routines.

Research shows that time pressure and fragmented schedules increase demand for convenient, low-effort solutions (OECD, 2023). Steamers address these needs through portability and ease of use, making them suitable for travel, hybrid work, and smaller living spaces.

Despite these advantages, adoption depends on whether consumers perceive steamers as genuinely useful rather than redundant. Unclear positioning and uncertainty regarding effectiveness may limit acceptance, particularly in markets where transparency and realistic performance claims are valued (Bockmühl et al., 2019).

Overall, the market gap lies not in lack of convenience needs, but in the limited diffusion of clearly positioned, portable garment-care technologies. Successful adoption in Denmark depends on emphasizing practicality, portability, and realistic use cases that fit everyday routines.

2.6 Synthesis: implications for innovation scouting

The literature reviewed in the sections above highlights that the successful diffusion of Chinese consumer electronics into the Danish market is shaped by a combination of consumer behaviour, cultural expectations, regulatory requirements, and everyday usage patterns. While Denmark represents an attractive market due to high purchasing power, digital maturity, and openness to innovation, these characteristics also create selective adoption conditions. As a result, technological success in the Chinese market does not automatically translate into commercial success in Denmark.

Across the three analyzed product categories, a common theme emerges: **market gaps are not primarily driven by a lack of consumer interest, but by mismatches between consumer expectations and how products are designed, positioned, and integrated into daily life**. These gaps differ in nature across the

product categories, which underlines the importance of evaluating products individually rather than assuming a one-size-fits-all diffusion strategy.

Taken together, these findings suggest that **effective innovation scouting requires more than identifying fast-growing or technologically advanced products in the Chinese market**. Instead, firms must assess how different types of consumer electronics interact with Danish consumer values, habits, and institutional expectations. Market gaps emerge not only at the level of product functionality, but also in relation to trust, usability, perceived relevance, and integration into daily life.

For Nine United, these insights underline the need for a structured and evidence-based approach to product selection. By combining knowledge of Chinese innovation trends with an in-depth understanding of Danish consumer behavior, it becomes possible to identify products that are not only technologically viable, but also commercially realistic in the Danish market. This synthesis provides the conceptual foundation for the following methodology chapter, which will empirically examine Danish consumer perceptions, adoption barriers, and preferred distribution channels in relation to the selected product categories.

3. Methodology

3.1 Research Philosophy

This study adopts a **pragmatic research philosophy**, combined with an **abductive research approach** and a **mixed-methods orientation**. Pragmatism focuses on practical knowledge that informs real-world decision-making rather than producing universally generalisable theory (Saunders et al., 2020). In this context, it supports Nine United's product scouting decisions by integrating theoretical frameworks with empirical insights from Danish consumers.

The abductive approach allows iterative movement between theory and empirical data. Initial literature on innovation diffusion, consumer behavior, and cross-market adaptation informed product screening and research design. Focus group and survey insights refined the application of these theories in the Danish consumer context. Abduction is particularly suited to market research, where neither purely deductive nor purely inductive approaches capture the complexity of real-world phenomena.

A mixed-methods orientation integrates qualitative and quantitative research. Focus groups enabled in-depth exploration of consumer perceptions, while surveys tested these insights across a larger sample. This combination supports both depth and breadth of analysis and ensures robust, actionable results.

3.2 Research Design

The study follows an exploratory, sequential mixed-methods design, appropriate for early-stage product evaluation.

The process consisted of three stages. First, product screening identified five Chinese consumer electronics products through secondary research and trend scouting in health, convenience, home living, and smart technologies.

Second, a qualitative focus group evaluated these products' relevance in the Danish context. Participants discussed perceived usefulness, adoption likelihood, and fit with local consumer habits. Insights narrowed the product set from five to three concepts with stronger perceived relevance.

Third, a quantitative survey measured consumer interest, perceived usefulness, adoption barriers, and preferred usage contexts for the three selected products. This validated and extended qualitative findings by identifying patterns across a larger sample.

This sequential design ensured that survey questions were grounded in consumer perspectives, providing evidence-based support for product selection decisions.

3.3 Data Collection

3.3.1 Focus Groups

The focus group aimed to explore Danish consumers' perceptions, needs, preferences, and decision-making barriers regarding potential consumer electronics. Its findings informed the subsequent quantitative survey and product evaluation.

Participants: Five core participants aged 18–44 with experience living in Denmark, representing diverse living situations such as small apartments, frequent travel, and pet ownership. Two observers were also present.

Outcome: Discussions highlighted key factors influencing product acceptance, including functional practicality, brand trust, and lifestyle compatibility. Based on these insights, the five initial products were narrowed to three for survey testing:

- UV toothbrush sanitizer
- Handheld garment steamer
- Hydroponic indoor garden

The focus group also informed survey design by identifying relevant measurement dimensions and appropriate price ranges for the products.

3.3.2 Survey

The survey quantitatively evaluated consumer interest, purchasing behavior, and decision-making drivers for the three shortlisted products. It built directly on the focus group findings, validating key insights and filling gaps such as price expectations, brand perceptions, and niche use cases.

The survey included screening and demographic questions (residency in Denmark, age 18–44), behavioral questions (past purchases of home electronics), brand perception questions (importance of brand, hesitations regarding unfamiliar brands), product-specific questions (appeal, price willingness, purchase motivations), and ranking of product relevance and preferred purchasing channels. The survey was brief, anonymous, and distributed through Google Forms.

Sampling: The target population was Danish residents aged 18–4. Convenience sampling leveraged relevant online communities and personal networks to ensure participants had experience with the Danish market. Screening excluded non-target respondents to maintain data relevance.

Distribution and Quality Control: The survey was promoted in active Danish online communities, and responses were monitored in real time to remove duplicates and incomplete entries. Data cleaning ensured high-quality, reliable datasets for analysis.

Outcome: Survey results confirmed focus group findings across a broader sample, validating product appeal, price sensitivity, and consumer interest. These data supported recommendations for drop shipping friendly products in Denmark.

4. Product Scouting Process

4.1 Initial Longlist and Shortlisting Logic

The product scouting process began with a broad exploration of emerging Chinese consumer electronics that demonstrate increasing relevance within European home-oriented consumption. Drawing on global innovation trends, platform-based product discovery, and preliminary market screening, a longlist of potential products was generated with particular attention to categories associated with hygiene, sustainability, convenience, and smart living. These domains were selected due to their strong conceptual alignment with Danish consumer values, which emphasize functionality, environmental responsibility, and seamless integration into everyday life. From this initial pool, three products were shortlisted for deeper evaluation: a UV toothbrush sterilizer, a hydroponic indoor garden, and a handheld electric steamer.

The transition from longlist to shortlist was not driven by novelty alone, but by an integrative assessment of consumer relevance, commercial feasibility, and long-term trend alignment. Insights from the preceding focus group interview and quantitative survey were used to evaluate how each product fits within Danish lifestyles, price expectations, and housing conditions. Rather than treating consumer responses as isolated indicators, the scouting process emphasized synthesis across qualitative and quantitative insights to identify products capable of sustaining market relevance beyond short-term experimentation. The shortlisted products thus represent distinct but complementary dimensions of home-focused innovation, each addressing different consumer motivations and usage contexts within the Danish market.

To further validate the quality and reliability of the three shortlisted products (UV toothbrush sterilizer, hydroponic indoor garden, and handheld electric steamer) and provide solid supporting evidence for their market entry feasibility in Denmark, this section elaborates on key information including their origins, manufacturer backgrounds, certification status, usage safety, and functional efficacy. The following content focuses on verifying the core quality attributes of each product, which is crucial for deepening the understanding of product competitiveness and reducing potential market risks.

4.2 Market-Level Synthesis of Shortlisted Products

UV Toothbrush Sterilizer

The UV toothbrush sterilizer emerged as the most strategically versatile product within the shortlist, demonstrating broad relevance across multiple consumer segments. Its core value proposition aligns closely with Danish priorities related to hygiene, health consciousness, and sustainability, while requiring minimal behavioral change from users. Rather than introducing a new routine, the product integrates seamlessly into existing daily practices, which significantly lowers adoption barriers. This integration is particularly relevant in the Danish context, where consumers tend to favor practical solutions that deliver tangible benefits without unnecessary complexity.



From a market perspective, the UV toothbrush sterilizer supports differentiated positioning rather than a single fixed identity. It can be framed as an affordable hygiene accessory for cost-conscious consumers or as a premium health-related device for buyers who place greater emphasis on quality, design, and brand

trust. This flexibility enables stratified pricing strategies and reduces dependency on one narrowly defined target group. Moreover, the product's compact design aligns well with the spatial limitations of urban Danish housing, reinforcing its everyday practicality. Combined with low sourcing costs and limited logistical complexity, the sterilizer represents a low-risk yet scalable product with strong potential for market diffusion.

The UV toothbrush sterilizer selected in this screening originates from the consumer electronics industrial cluster in the Pearl River Delta of China, where a number of manufacturers specializing in the R&D and production of smart home hygiene products are concentrated, with mature capabilities in precision electronic component integration and sterilization technology application. The product relies on UVC deep ultraviolet sterilization technology as its core, and its sterilization efficacy has been verified by authoritative institutions — according to the certification reports issued by Guangdong Provincial Center for Microbial Analysis and Testing and Guangzhou Institute of Microbiology Co., Ltd., the sterilization rate against Escherichia coli and Staphylococcus aureus both reaches 99.99%, which can achieve deep sterilization of toothbrushes and effectively solve the core pain point of bacterial residue on toothbrushes after brushing.

In terms of usage safety and quality stability, the product adopts a triple protection design to ensure reliability: in addition to the core UVC sterilization module, it is equipped with hot air drying and electric heating components, which not only avoids the odor problem caused by damp and air-drying of toothbrushes, but also inhibits the secondary growth of bacteria through a dry environment, cutting off the bacterial growth chain from the source. The electrical components of the product comply with international safety standards and have passed strict insulation, high-temperature resistance and service life tests to ensure electrical safety during long-term use. There are no potential safety hazards such as ultraviolet leakage and overheating, and its quality and reliability have been double verified by authoritative testing and actual use scenarios.

Hydroponic Indoor Garden

In contrast, the hydroponic indoor garden represents a fundamentally different form of market opportunity. Rather than appealing broadly, its relevance is concentrated within a clearly defined niche of consumers who value sustainability, aesthetics, and food transparency. The product's appeal is less functional in the traditional sense and more symbolic, reflecting lifestyle aspirations related to self-sufficiency, environmental awareness, and interior design. While overall interest is polarized, those

consumers who do find the product appealing demonstrate a willingness to invest at higher price points, suggesting that the product is perceived as a long-term lifestyle addition rather than a disposable gadget.











This positioning limits the hydroponic garden’s suitability for mass-market strategies but strengthens its potential within a premium niche framework. Success for this product depends on careful branding, design integration, and communication that emphasizes simplicity and lifestyle enhancement rather than traditional gardening. In the Danish market, where interior aesthetics and sustainable living carry significant cultural value, the hydroponic indoor garden can function as a hybrid between home decor and wellness technology. Although its reach is narrower than the other shortlisted products, its higher price tolerance and symbolic value offer attractive margins for a targeted drop-shipping approach.

This hydroponic indoor garden originates from the intelligent agricultural equipment industrial belt in the Yangtze River Delta of China. The manufacturer has deep experience in the field of smart home gardening equipment and owns a complete R&D, production and quality control system. The core advantage of the product lies in the full-chain intelligent control and safety guarantee design, and it has passed several authoritative certifications, including the three major certifications of China's ISO system, the pollution-free agricultural product origin certification and the pollution-free vegetable certification inspection. Both the production process and the quality of the finally produced vegetables meet the safety standards.

In terms of efficacy, the intelligent lighting system equipped with the product adopts LED full-spectrum fill lights, which can simulate sunlight at a 1:1 ratio, accurately matching the light intensity and light quality required for the growth of leafy vegetables, ensuring sufficient photosynthesis, stable growth cycle and good growth condition of vegetables; the intelligent circulation system adopts the internationally advanced NFT seedling raising layer and ebb and flow irrigation technology to ensure the uniform supply of nutrient solution and avoid root rot caused by water accumulation. In terms of safety,

the main body of the product is made of food-grade PP material, which has the characteristics of acid and alkali resistance, insulation and wear resistance, non-toxic and harmless, and can directly contact vegetables without the precipitation of harmful substances; the purity of the raw materials used in the supporting nutrient solution reaches 99.99%, which is much higher than that of ordinary fertilizers, minimizing the harm of harmful substances such as heavy metal ions in ordinary fertilizers and ensuring that the grown vegetables are healthy and edible. In addition, the intelligent control system can adjust the lighting mode and water circulation interval in real time, and alarm in time when the water level is too low, further improving the convenience and reliability of use.



外形尺寸：770mm（长）X400mm（宽）X1700mm（高）

Dimensions: 770mm (length) X400mm (width) X1700mm (height)

Handheld Electric Steamer

The handheld electric steamer occupies a middle position within the shortlist, characterized by consistent mass-market relevance rather than emotional or aspirational appeal. Its value lies in its practicality and alignment with Danish attitudes toward clothing and daily routines. Danish consumers generally place less emphasis on formal appearance and traditional ironing yet still encounter situations where quick garment refreshment is desirable. The handheld steamer addresses this need by offering a convenient, time-saving alternative that avoids the effort and space requirements associated with conventional ironing equipment.

Unlike the hydroponic garden, the steamer does not rely on lifestyle signaling, nor does it require extensive consumer education. Its adoption is supported by immediate functional understanding and low perceived risk. This makes it particularly suitable for younger consumers, frequent travelers, and urban residents with limited living space. From a commercial standpoint, the steamer benefits from very low sourcing costs, strong price accessibility, and minimal after-sales complexity. While it lacks the differentiation and symbolic value of the UV sterilizer, it compensates through reliability, universality, and volume potential, making it a stable performer within a drop-shipping model.

The handheld electric steamer selected in this screening originates from the core production area of China's small household appliance industry. The manufacturer is a well-known domestic small household appliance enterprise (such as Aux, etc.), with mature R&D and production experience in steam equipment and a sound product quality control system. Its efficacy has been verified by professional laboratories. According to the measurement data of Aux Laboratory, its mite and bacteria removal rate reaches 99.99%, which can effectively eliminate mites and bacteria on clothes. At the same time, the steam is strong, which can penetrate clothes in one second, quickly soften fibers and smooth wrinkles. It can complete preheating within 20 seconds, which can efficiently meet the urgent demand for clothes refreshing.

In terms of quality and safety, the product adopts a stainless steel panel design, which is suitable for various fabrics such as cotton, linen, silk and wool, avoiding damage to clothes while achieving wrinkle removal function; the body is equipped with safety devices such as overheating protection and dry burning prevention, which will automatically power off when the equipment temperature is too high or the water volume is insufficient, eliminating potential safety hazards. The product complies with national safety standards for small household appliances and has passed electrical safety performance testing. It

has reached high industry levels in key indicators such as steam pressure stability and service life, ensuring reliability and durability in daily use.













4.3 Integrated Shortlisting Criteria

Market fit served as the primary evaluative dimension in the shortlisting process. Each product was assessed according to how naturally it aligns with Danish consumer values, routines, and constraints. The UV toothbrush sterilizer addresses everyday hygiene concerns while supporting sustainability through reduced waste, the handheld steamer responds to time efficiency and minimalist living preferences, and the hydroponic garden appeals to lifestyle-driven sustainability and aesthetic self-expression. This differentiation ensures that the shortlist captures multiple consumer motivations rather than competing within a single functional category.

Operational feasibility further reinforced the selection of these products. All three are widely available from Chinese manufacturers at low sourcing costs, enabling attractive margins within a drop-shipping framework. They fall within relatively low-risk electronic categories and require only standard CE certification, which is essential for building consumer trust in the Danish market and penetrating the market legally, complying with EU standards. Additionally, their compact size and durability reduce logistical challenges related to shipping, storage, and returns. Compared to more technically complex or maintenance-intensive products, the shortlisted items minimize customer service demands and operational uncertainty, increasing their suitability for market entry.

Trend alignment was incorporated to ensure that the shortlisted products reflect not only current preferences but also evolving consumption patterns. The UV toothbrush sterilizer and handheld steamer both align with the broader trend of hygiene-conscious and efficiency-oriented living, which has gained sustained relevance in the post-pandemic context. The hydroponic indoor garden, meanwhile, reflects growing interest in accessible wellness, sustainable food practices, and environmentally conscious

lifestyles. Together, these trends point toward a shift in Danish consumption toward small, incremental improvements that enhance everyday life without requiring major lifestyle overhauls.

4.4 Section Conclusion

In synthesis, the product scouting process prioritized strategic coherence and commercial viability over surface-level popularity. The UV toothbrush sterilizer stands out as the most balanced option, combining scalability, differentiation, and strong alignment with Danish values. The handheld electric steamer provides dependable mass-market potential through functional relevance and ease of adoption, while the hydroponic indoor garden offers high-margin opportunities within a clearly defined lifestyle niche. Collectively, these products form a complementary portfolio that enables a nuanced analysis of market diffusion potential for Chinese consumer electronics in Denmark. By integrating consumer insights, feasibility considerations, and trend analysis, the scouting process establishes a robust foundation for subsequent evaluation and strategic recommendation.

5 Data analysis

5.1 Focus Group Interview Analysis

Basic Interview Information

The focus group interview was conducted online for 1 hour, hosted by Speaker A, with participants including Speaker B, Speaker C, Speaker D, Speaker E, and the Triple Helix Team—all of whom are Speaker A's friends, all with Danish backgrounds. The core topic was to select 3 commercial electronic products with the potential to be hits in the Danish market (targeting drop shipping options) through gathering participants' perceptions, usage needs, price expectations, and rankings of 5 shortlisted products. The insights will inform a follow-up survey for Danish Facebook groups and a collaborative project with a Danish company.

Product-by-Product Detailed Feedback and Insights

Portable Mite Remover

This small handheld wireless device uses suction and UV/blue light (depending on the model) to remove dust, mites, pet hair, and other debris from fabrics like bedding, sofas, carpets, plush items, and clothing.

It was selected for its design and functionality, aligning with the "blue ocean strategy" of targeting less commercialized products in Denmark.

Participants held mixed views on the product. On the positive side, Speaker D appreciated the UV light add-on for disinfection, while Speaker E liked its multifunctional design and compact size, noting the disinfection feature as a key appeal. However, several barriers emerged. Speaker C expressed trust issues, worrying that the device might damage nice clothing or expensive furniture, as they were unfamiliar with its working mechanism. Speaker B pointed out that its small size would make cleaning large items like coats time-consuming and questioned its necessity—arguing that an iron and IKEA dust roller already met their needs. Speaker C further criticized its overly broad multifunctionality, stating they preferred specialized devices over one that claims to clean dust, carpets, and clothes, as using the same tool for such different tasks felt odd and its core strength was unclear. Speaker E, despite liking the multifunctionality, admitted they would not use the same device on sofas (which meet outdoor clothing) and scarves (close to the face), and ultimately would not buy it due to a preference for avoiding "random" devices when a simple roller suffices.

Price expectations varied significantly. Most participants (Speaker D, B, E) cited a range of 100–200 Danish kroner (DKK), with Speaker D setting a maximum of 150 DKK, Speaker B at 100–150 DKK, and Speaker E at up to 200 DKK—comparing it to cheap alternatives like 10–15 DKK kids' store rollers. In contrast, Speaker C argued that a fair price for those with specific needs could be up to 800 DKK, considering the electronics, mechanics, UV light, and build quality required. Market price references revealed a stark difference: the product is available for ~35 DKK (36 Chinese yuan) on Alibaba and ~150 DKK (21–23 USD) on Amazon. Speaker A also noted its potential appeal for families with kids needing sanitization for toys, strollers, and surfaces, beyond just clothing.

Handheld Steamer

A compact, lightweight, and travel-friendly steamer suitable for all fabrics, Speaker A (who owns one) praised its practicality, noting it is not widely seen in Denmark despite lacking unique functionalities. Its key selling points were its small size, space-saving design, and ease of travel.

Participants recognized its portability as a major advantage. Speaker D, who often runs late, valued its ability to be packed in a bag for on-the-go use at events, while Speaker C appreciated its compactness and light weight (around 700 grams with water, less than 1 kilo) as ideal for travel and lazy users. However, barriers were tied to Danish lifestyle and product differentiation. Speaker B stated that price would be the deciding factor since it did not differ much from existing steamers and questioned its longevity. Speaker E, who does not iron regularly, noted that hanging clothes to dry suffices for most occasions in Denmark, where formal clothing is unpopular sharing a story of being able to go out in pajamas without judgment.

Speaker B echoed this, suggesting the product may not be a wise business decision given Danes' low emphasis on wrinkle-free clothing. Speaker D also raised concerns about steam power, worrying that if it took 15 minutes to steam one garment, it would be a dealbreaker—though Speaker A clarified that their model heats up in 1 minute and works faster than traditional irons.

Price expectations ranged from 60–400 DKK. Speaker D cited 60–200 DKK, Speaker E and B 100–200 DKK, and Speaker C 150–400 DKK. Market prices are notably lower: ~20 DKK on some sites and ~120–215 DKK (17–30 USD) on Amazon.

White Noise Sleep Machine

Modeled after concepts like Philips Hue, this device functions as a wake-up alarm with white noise for sleep and gradual light/sound activation e.g., brightening a room from 6:45 AM for a 7 AM wake-up—addressing Denmark's dark-month sleep challenges.

The light feature was a key positive for some participants. Speaker E valued it for helping establish a consistent sleep routine, as shifting bedtimes and dark weather make sleep and wakefulness difficult. They noted they would buy it if it included vibration (since they do not respond to sound alarms and find them stressful), but not if it only had sound. However, Speaker C rejected the product outright, stating they did not need a separate device for these functions. Brand reliability emerged as a critical concern: Speaker B mentioned a long-standing stereotype that Chinese-manufactured products (like those on Temu and AliExpress) are lower quality, even if untrue. Speaker C countered that origin matters less than brand experience—trusting established brands with a history of reliable technology over unknown new brands, noting that even big brands manufacture in China.

Price expectations were highly variable. Speaker E cited 400–800 DKK, while Speaker B initially mocked its low perceived value with a maximum of 20–30 DKK (comparing it to cheap Temu deals) before adjusting to 300 DKK for the concept. Speaker D aligned with Speaker B's adjusted range, citing up to 300 DKK, while Speaker C leaned toward Speaker E's higher range for a quality product. Market references include 42 DKK on some sites, ~250–325 DKK (35–45 USD) on Amazon, and Philips' equivalent at 200 EUR (1,500 DKK)—a price participants found steep but justified by Philips' branding.

Hydroponic Home Garden

This indoor gardening unit uses LED lights to grow small greens, vegetables, and herbs, emphasizing better quality, pesticide-free produce, and transparent food sourcing.

The concept appealed to some participants but faced significant barriers. Speaker E liked the idea of a mini version for herbs (given their small apartment) and appreciated its utility in winter, though space was a major constraint. Speaker B had sought a large, robust outdoor version but found most available

products too small (air fryer-sized) to be useful, stating they would pay 10,000+ DKK for a functional large model but not 2,000+ DKK for a small one. Speaker C noted they lacked space and natural light for growing plants, doubting LED effectiveness compared to farmers' optimal conditions, though they acknowledged the benefit of pesticide-free produce. Participants also raised maintenance concerns: the need for specialized nutrient solutions, replacement parts (like rock wool), and ongoing costs. Aesthetic appeal was another key factor, as Danes prioritize interior design—Speaker C emphasized the product must offer varied colors, materials, and designs to be acceptable. Speaker D had no interest in the product, stating they would only take it for free from a recycling area.

Price expectations for apartment-friendly small versions were 200–300 DKK (Speaker E), while large, functional models garnered 10,000+ DKK from interested participants (Speaker B). The estimated Danish market price is ~1,000 DKK, based on ~400 DKK in the Chinese market.

UV Toothbrush Sterilizer

This device disinfects toothbrushes with UV light, holds 1–2 toothbrushes (with a smaller travel version available), and some models include a toothpaste dispenser. It received the most positive feedback of all products.

Participants praised its hygiene and sustainability benefits. Speaker D noted it addresses fears of bathroom bacteria contamination (even with flushed toilet lids) and provides peace of mind. Speaker E highlighted its ability to extend toothbrush lifespan—reducing replacements from every 2–4 weeks to 8–10 weeks—lowering waste and supporting sustainability. Speaker B described it as a "must-have" if marketed effectively, noting it has no obvious flaws, though the displayed model was overly bulky. They suggested a compact, travel-friendly design (covering only the toothbrush tip) and criticized the unnecessary toothpaste dispenser. Speaker C agreed the device could be smaller and portable but found the large version aesthetically pleasing for bathrooms, calling it the best product overall. Minor counterpoints included Speaker C's suggestion that covered storage in cupboards suffices, and their habit of replacing toothbrushes due to worn bristles (not dirt). Speaker D also raised a niche concern: a Huberman Lab podcast suggested separate toothbrushes for teeth and tongue due to different bacteria, and they wondered if UV disinfection might kill beneficial bacteria.

Price expectations ranged from 200–500 DKK, aligning with perceived value. Speaker D would pay 500 DKK (as a gift), Speaker B 200–400 DKK (for a small, quality model), Speaker E 250–400 DKK (for 1–2 toothbrushes), and Speaker C 300–500 DKK. Market price on Temu is ~70 DKK, making it a cost-effective option for Danish consumers.

Product Ranking and Closing Details

After discussing all products, participants were asked to rank them 1–5 based on purchase likelihood or relevance, but the scale was initially ambiguous: some used 1 as "most likely to buy" and 5 as "least," while others reversed it (1 = not buy, 5 = definitely buy). Despite the confusion, a clear trend emerged: the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer was the top favorite, followed by the Handheld Steamer in the second tier. The Portable Mite Remover and White Noise Sleep Machine received mixed interest, while the Hydroponic Home Garden had the lowest appeal.

Speaker A shared market price insights from Chinese sources, highlighting that participants' price expectations were generally higher than sourcing costs—creating potential profit margins. The team plans to use the feedback to design a follow-up survey and pitch the top products in Shanghai in two months, with a focus on driving demand for the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer. Participants requested free samples, and Speaker A noted they could source the UV sterilizer for 40 DKK (compared to 500 DKK in Danish stores), emphasizing branding's impact on perceived value.

Section Key Findings and Comprehensive Conclusions

Key Findings

- Price Sensitivity and Profit Potential: Most participants expected products under 400 DKK, with significant gaps between their expectations and Chinese sourcing costs—offering strong profit margins for drop shipping. Overpriced or niche products (e.g., large hydroponic gardens) were rejected outright.
- Danish Lifestyle Alignment: Product success hinges on fitting local habits: compact designs for small apartments (critical for the steamer, mite remover, and sterilizer), low emphasis on formal clothing (limiting the steamer's appeal), prioritization of interior design (a must for the hydroponic garden), and adaptation to dark months (a strength of the sleep machine's light feature).
- Functionality and Clarity: Overly multifunctional products (e.g., portable mite remover) caused skepticism, as participants preferred specialized tools with clear core uses. Products with distinct, practical benefits (e.g., UV disinfection, portability) resonated more strongly.
- Hygiene and Sustainability: UV-enabled products (toothbrush sterilizer, mite remover) and sustainable features (extended toothbrush lifespan) were major drivers of interest, reflecting Danish priorities for health and environmental responsibility.
- Brand Trust Over Origin: "Made in China" was not a dealbreaker, but unknown brands raised reliability concerns. Established brands (e.g., Philips) commanded higher price tolerance, while new brands would need to emphasize quality and trust.

- Barrier Variation: Barriers were product-specific: space and maintenance for the hydroponic garden, perceived necessity for the sleep machine, trust and alternative products for the mite remover, and lifestyle misalignment for the steamer.

Conclusions

While survey participants expressed interest in the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer, Handheld Steamer, and Portable Mite Remover during interviews, a comprehensive assessment of market competition and potential life value revealed that the Hydroponic Home Garden holds the greatest potential in the Danish and Nordic markets. This is primarily because it directly meets Danish residents' daily demand for fresh fruit and vegetable cultivation—a core lifestyle need that outweighs the limitations of other niche products. Detailed analysis of each product is as follows:

· **UV Toothbrush Sterilizer:** It received enthusiastic feedback, with clear hygiene and sustainability benefits aligned with Danish values. The only barrier—bulkiness of the displayed model—can be easily addressed through a compact, travel-friendly redesign. Its price expectation (200–500 DKK) is well above sourcing costs (~70 DKK), offering strong profit potential, and effective marketing could reinforce its "must-have" status. However, its market potential is overshadowed by the hydroponic garden, as its value proposition (hygiene enhancement) is narrower than the hydroponic garden's ability to fulfill a fundamental need for fresh, home-grown produce.

· **Handheld Steamer:** Its portability and practicality appeal to frequent travelers, busy professionals, and those needing quick fabric touch-ups. While it targets a viable niche, Danish lifestyle limits its broad appeal. Price sensitivity is manageable given low sourcing costs (~20 DKK) and positioning it as a travel essential could expand its market. Nevertheless, its niche positioning means it cannot compete with the hydroponic garden's broader resonance with mainstream Danish consumers' desire for self-sustaining, fresh food sources.

· **Portable Mite Remover:** Despite mixed views, it has niche potential for families with kids, pet owners, or those prioritizing hygiene. Success would require redesigning to emphasize specialized use cases (e.g., clothing or pet hair removal) rather than broad multifunctionality, addressing durability concerns, and pricing within the 100–200 DKK range (aligning with most participants' expectations). However, its targeted user base is too narrow compared to the hydroponic garden, which caters to a more universal demand for fresh produce in urban Nordic settings.

· **Hydroponic Home Garden (Most Recommended):** Contrary to initial mixed feedback, this product emerges as the most promising option for the Danish market due to its direct alignment with residents' demand for fresh fruit and vegetable cultivation. While initial concerns included space constraints, high

maintenance, size dissatisfaction, and low interest from some demographics, these are addressable challenges rather than insurmountable barriers. A cost-effective, aesthetically pleasing, and low-maintenance apartment-sized model—tailored to urban living spaces in Denmark—would effectively mitigate these concerns. Given its ability to fulfill a core lifestyle need (fresh, home-grown produce) that resonates with Nordic values of sustainability and self-sufficiency, the investment in optimizing this product is justified and holds greater long-term market potential than the other three niche products.

· **White Noise Sleep Machine (Less Recommended):** This product remains less recommended, as its appeal is limited by perceived redundancy with phones and reliance on established branding. For it to be viable, it would need vibration features and association with a trusted brand—changes that do not justify the investment given its narrow value proposition compared to the hydroponic garden.

Implications for quantitative surveys

The focus group interview served as a critical preliminary foundation for designing the subsequent Home & Lifestyle Products survey, aiming to gather in-depth qualitative insights into Danish consumers' attitudes, needs, pain points, and preferences regarding potential commercial electronic products—ultimately ensuring the survey's questions are targeted, relevant, and aligned with local market realities. Notably, the interview not only identified key products for further investigation but also reached a pivotal conclusion that would guide the survey's focus: while participants expressed interest in products like the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer, Handheld Electric Steamer, and Portable Mite Remover, the Hydroponic Indoor Garden emerged as the most promising option for the Danish market due to its direct alignment with local residents' demand for fresh fruit and vegetable cultivation. This core finding shaped the survey's emphasis on validating and quantifying market potential for the hydroponic garden, alongside exploring the niche value of other products.

During the interview, participants discussed core products that later became the focus of the survey—including the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer, Hydroponic Indoor Garden, and Handheld Electric Steamer—alongside two other items (Portable Mite Remover and White Noise Sleep Machine) to refine the final product set. Their feedback highlighted critical dimensions to incorporate into the survey, with particular attention to factors relevant to the high-potential hydroponic garden. For instance, concerns about brand reputation and origin (with participants noting skepticism toward unfamiliar brands and stereotypes around manufacturing sources) translated into the survey's question on the importance of brand reputation and origin—an inquiry especially vital for the hydroponic garden, as building trust in a relatively novel home cultivation product is key to market acceptance. Discussions about price sensitivity—with participants citing specific ranges for each product (e.g., 200–500 DKK for the UV Toothbrush Sterilizer,

200–1500 DKK for the Hydroponic Indoor Garden)—informed the survey's predefined price options for each product, ensuring these choices reflected real consumer expectations, particularly for the hydroponic garden where price alignment could significantly impact its adoption.

Additionally, the interview uncovered key purchase motivations (e.g., hygiene, portability, sustainability, and for the hydroponic garden, the desire for fresh, home-grown produce) and barriers (e.g., size constraints, perceived redundancy, lack of reviews—with size and maintenance concerns being primary for the hydroponic garden). These insights shaped the survey's open-ended and multiple-choice questions about motivating factors and hesitations toward new brands, with tailored prompts to explore concerns specific to the hydroponic garden. Participants' emphasis on lifestyle alignment—such as compact designs for small Danish apartments, low maintenance for busy users, and compatibility with casual local dress norms—was particularly critical for the hydroponic garden's survey design, ensuring the product's descriptions and relevance-ranking questions highlighted optimized features (e.g., apartment-sized, low-maintenance models) that address core barriers. Demographic factors like age groups and prior residency in Denmark, which were highlighted as important for segmenting feedback during the interview, were integrated as mandatory opening questions in the survey to enable targeted analysis—especially valuable for understanding which consumer segments show the strongest demand for the hydroponic garden.

Finally, the interview's product ranking exercise (which reinforced the hydroponic garden's potential despite initial concerns) and discussions about preferred purchase channels (e.g., electronics stores, online marketplaces, brand web shops) directly informed the survey's closing ranking task and multi-select question on purchasing preferences. The ranking task was designed to further quantify the hydroponic garden's appeal relative to other products, while the purchase channel question aimed to identify the most effective distribution channels for promoting the hydroponic garden to Danish consumers. By leveraging these qualitative insights—with a focused lens on validating the hydroponic garden's market potential—the survey was designed to quantify the focus group's exploratory findings, ensuring it captures actionable data on consumer interest and purchasing behavior in the Danish market while addressing the specific concerns and priorities identified during the preliminary interview phase, especially those related to the most promising product: the Hydroponic Indoor Garden.

5.2 Survey Data Analysis

Survey Rationale and Foundational Alignment

The quantitative survey was strategically developed as a follow-up to the earlier focus group interview, serving as a critical bridge between qualitative insights and data-driven market validation. Its core purpose was to expand on the focus group's findings—where five shortlisted electronic products were discussed, and three standout candidates (UV toothbrush sterilizer, handheld steamer labeled as "Electric Iron" for broader consumer recognition, and hydroponic indoor garden) emerged—to systematically measure Danish consumers' interest, purchasing behavior, and decision-making drivers. The survey was designed to address gaps identified in the focus group, such as varying price expectations, conflicting attitudes toward brand origin versus reliability, and niche use-case preferences, while validating the initial product relevance rankings. Aligned with the overarching research goal of identifying drop shipping-friendly products with high potential in the Danish market, the survey aimed to gather actionable, scalable data that would complement the focus group's qualitative feedback, resulting in a holistic understanding of target consumer needs.

Survey Construction: Design, Structure, and Question Rationale

The survey was designed based directly on the key insights from the focus group. We intentionally structured each section and question to collect meaningful and multi-dimensional consumer data, while keeping the survey clear, concise, and relevant. To ensure easy access and a high response rate, we created the survey using Google Forms and designed it to take approximately three minutes to complete. This short completion time was a deliberate choice to reduce respondent fatigue and encourage honest and thoughtful answers. To further limit response bias, especially for sensitive topics such as price sensitivity and trust in brands, we clearly communicated that all responses were anonymous.

The survey began with two screening and demographic questions to ensure that the responses were relevant to the Danish market. The first question, *"Do you live or have you lived in Denmark?"*, functioned as a screening mechanism to exclude participants without direct experience of Danish consumer culture. This decision was aligned with the focus group's emphasis on products that fit local lifestyles. The second question, *"What is your age group?"*, divided respondents into the categories 18–24, 25–34, and 35–44. These age groups were selected because the focus group identified young to middle-aged consumers as the most likely to adopt new lifestyle gadgets and engage with drop-shipped consumer electronics.

The following sections focused on collecting behavioral and attitudinal data to better contextualize the product-specific responses. We included the question *"How many small home electronics or lifestyle*

gadgets have you bought this year?" to understand participants' baseline engagement with similar products and to distinguish between frequent adopters and more occasional buyers. Several brand-related questions were also included, such as *"How important is brand reputation and origin when buying small electronic products?"*, measured on a Likert-style scale, and *"What factors would make you hesitant to buy from a new or unfamiliar brand?"*. These questions directly reflected concerns raised in the focus group, particularly regarding trust, perceived quality, and skepticism toward unknown or Chinese-manufactured brands. The response options for hesitation (e.g. low trust in quality, concerns about safety or CE certification, and lack of reviews or recommendations) were derived directly from focus group discussions, ensuring that the survey captured real consumer concerns.

The core section of the survey focused on the three shortlisted products. To allow for direct comparison, we asked the same set of questions for each product. Participants were asked to rate *how appealing* each product was, indicate *the maximum price they would be willing to pay*, and explain *what would motivate them to buy the product*. These questions were informed by the focus group discussions around acceptable price ranges—such as 100–200 DKK for the portable mite remover and 200–500 DKK for the UV toothbrush sterilizer—as well as key motivating factors like hygiene benefits and portability.

To further validate the focus group's initial product preferences, we included a ranking question asking respondents to rank the three products based on personal relevance. Finally, a question on preferred purchasing channels (e.g. electronics retailers such as Elgiganten, online marketplaces like Amazon or Temu, and supermarkets) was included to generate practical distribution insights. This reflected the focus group's tendency to rely on trusted and familiar retail channels when purchasing consumer electronics.

Sampling Strategy: Target Population, Inclusion Criteria, and Sample Profile

The sampling strategy was intentionally designed to align with the focus group's demographic and market focus, prioritizing relevance over broad generalizability to ensure the data reflected the needs of the target consumer segment. The primary target population was defined as individuals who live or have lived in Denmark (to ensure familiarity with local market dynamics, lifestyle habits, and purchasing behaviors) and fall within the 18-44 age range but mostly aiming for younger targets between 18-34 (the core demographic for home and lifestyle gadgets, as identified in the focus group).

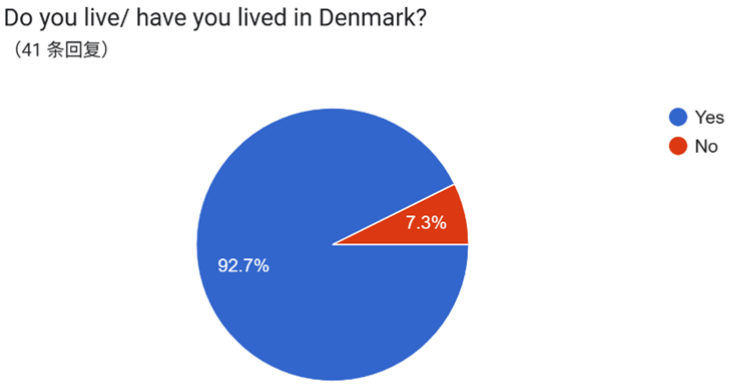
For the inclusion criteria, we selected only participants who answered "Yes" to the residency question were included in the final analysis, while those who selected "No" were excluded due to their lack of direct Danish market experience. This resulted in 36 valid responses, a sample size sufficient for identifying clear trends and validating focus group insights—particularly given the survey's targeted

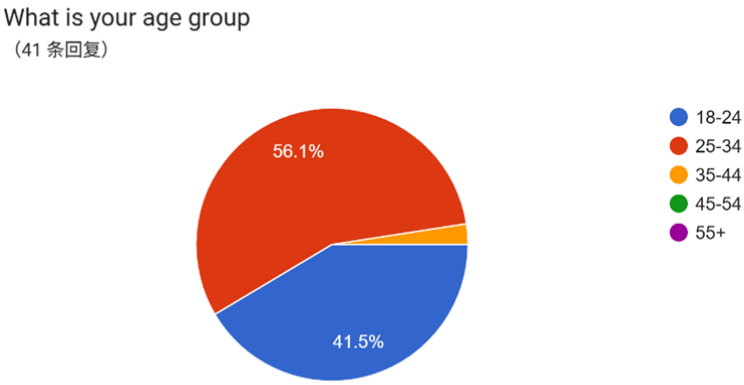
scope. The age distribution of the sample was concentrated in the two most relevant brackets: 12 participants (33.3%) in the 18-24 group and 22 participants (61.1%) in the 25-34 group, with only 2 participants (5.6%) in the 35-44 group. This skew reflected the research's focus on younger consumers, who are more likely to embrace new technologies, engage with drop shipping platforms, and prioritize the lifestyle features highlighted in the products (e.g., portability, sustainability, hygiene).

The sampling method we used was convenience sampling, leveraging the research team's access to Danish communities through online channels—including Facebook groups dedicated to home lifestyle, electronics, and Danish consumer discussions, as well as word-of-mouth networks connected to the team. This approach was chosen for its practicality and ability to reach the target demographic efficiently, as traditional probability sampling would have been logistically challenging for a niche research project focused on specific products. While convenience sampling limits the generalizability of the results to the entire Danish population, it ensured the sample was composed of engaged, relevant participants who are part of the core market for the three products. The sample's purchasing behavior further validated its relevance: 27 participants (75%) reported buying at least one small home electronic or lifestyle gadget in the year, with 10 (27.8%) purchasing three or more—indicating a group actively engaged with similar products and thus more likely to provide informed feedback.

Overall, the survey's construction, sampling, and distribution were meticulously aligned with the earlier focus group's insights and the research's core goals, resulting in a cohesive, data-driven approach to understanding Danish consumer preferences for the three shortlisted products. The combination of qualitative focus group feedback and quantitative survey data provides a robust foundation for identifying high-potential products and developing targeted market strategies for the Danish market.

Respondent Profile (Sample Demographics)





A total of 41 valid responses were collected for this survey. The sample demonstrates a strong focus on the core Danish consumer market. Most respondents (92.7%) are based in Denmark, ensuring that the collected data is highly relevant and reflective of the domestic market's perceptions and behaviors. All respondents belong to the 18-44 age bracket, representing the key consumer segments of young adults and professionals. The sample is particularly concentrated within the 25-34 age group, which constitutes 56.1% of all respondents. This indicates that the findings are most representative of this digitally native, economically active, and early-adopter demographic.

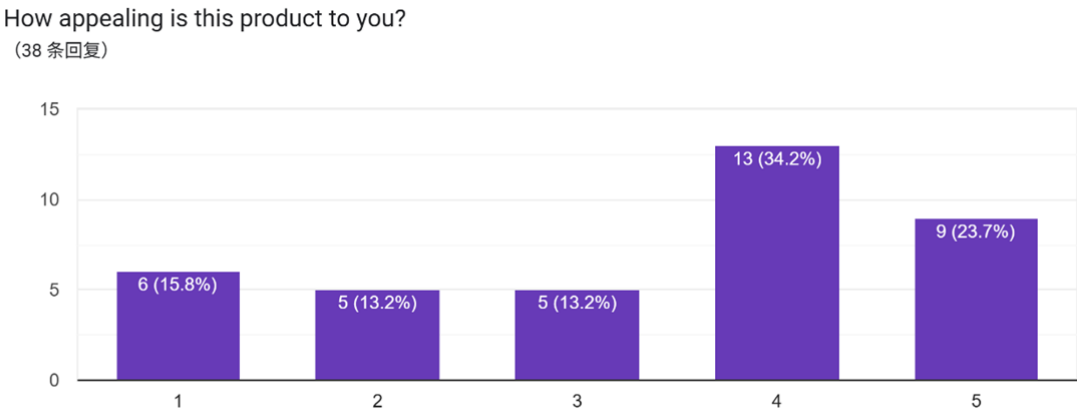
Barriers to Entry for New Brands

The top three concerns are strongly related to perceived risk and credibility, which are crucial for the young, predominantly Danish sample. The overwhelming emphasis on quality and reliability (75.6%)

underscores a fundamental requirement in the Danish market. Despite being a younger demographic (18-44 years), respondents prioritize long-term value and performance over novelty alone. This suggests that any new brand must provide strong, verifiable proof of product durability and functionality. The high percentage citing lack of reviews (61%) highlights the importance of social proof and peer validation in the decision-making process. This demographic heavily relies on online research and community feedback. A new brand without an established base of user testimonials, expert reviews, or visible recommendations will face significant distrust. The fact that "appearing cheap" is a major hesitation factor (51.2%) is particularly insightful. It indicates that competing solely on low price could be detrimental if it compromises the perceived value, design, or brand image. Danish consumers in this age group are likely seeking a balance between cost and premium perception—affordability should not equate to low quality.

Detailed Results for Products

Product 1: UV Toothbrush Sterilizer

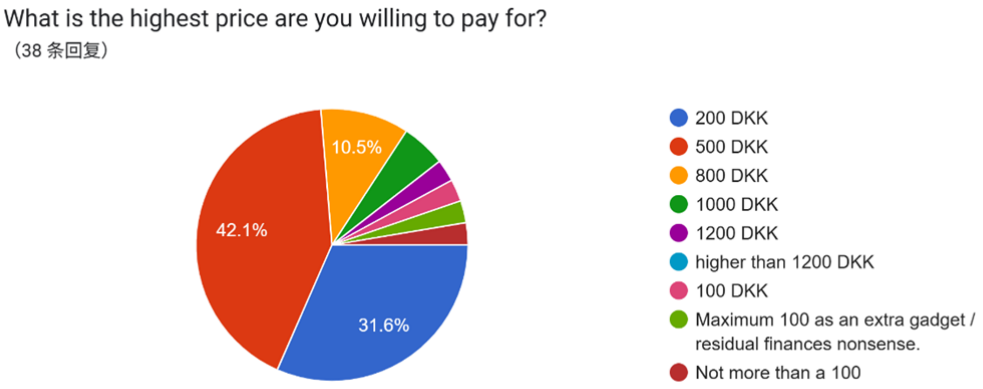


Product Concept Attractiveness

Respondents were asked to rate the general attractiveness of a **UV Toothbrush Sterilizer** on a scale (presumably 1-5, where 1=Not at all attractive, 5=Very attractive).

- **Mean Score: 3.37**
- **Mode (Most Frequent Score): 4** (selected by **34.2%** of respondents)

The average score of 3.37 indicates a moderately positive initial reception to the product concept. It is neither overwhelmingly exciting nor dismissible. The fact that the mode is 4 (a solidly positive rating) suggests there is a substantial segment of interested early adopters within the sample. This "interested segment" likely overlaps with the health-conscious and tech-inclined individuals in the 25-34 age bracket who see value in hygiene innovation. However, the mean being pulled below the mode indicates that a significant portion of respondents remain neutral or skeptical, potentially due to perceived novelty, necessity, or the barriers identified below.



Price Sensitivity & Willingness to Pay (WTP)

The survey results for the maximum acceptable price reveal a broader and more stratified range of price tolerance than previously understood, indicating distinct consumer segments.

The distribution is as follows:

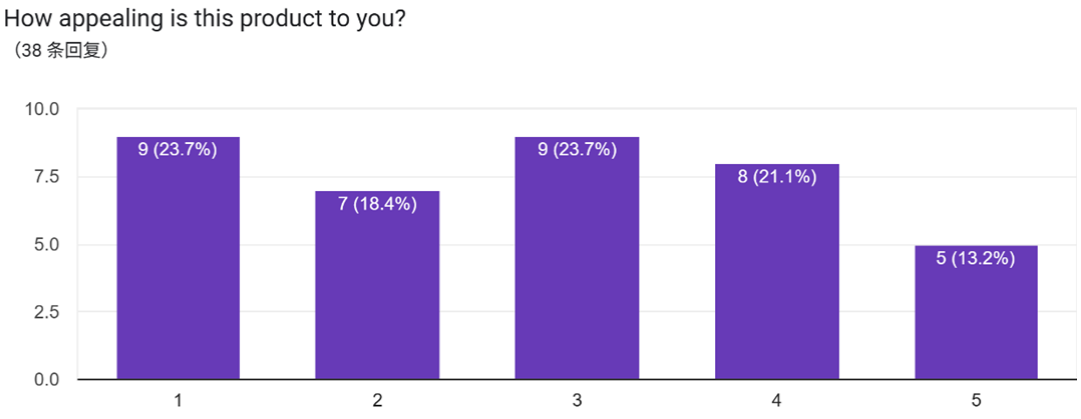
- **42.1%** of respondents are willing to pay a maximum of **200 DKK**.
- **31.6%** are willing to pay up to **500 DKK**.
- **10.5%** are willing to pay up to **800 DKK**.
- The remaining **15.8%** (inferred) either selected a lower option (e.g., 100 DKK) not listed here or a price above 800 DKK.

This three-tiered structure suggests a market segmented not just by basic price sensitivity, but by fundamentally different perceptions of the product's value proposition—from a basic accessory to a premium health-tech device. A Significant Premium Market Segment Exists: The fact that over 42% of respondents (31.6% + 10.5%) are willing to pay 500 DKK or more is a critical finding. This reveals a

substantial consumer base that does not view the product as a low-value commodity but as a substantive purchase. This segment likely associates the product with significant quality, effective technology, strong design, and trusted brand equity—directly addressing the previously stated hesitations about quality and "cheap" appearance.

Product 2: Hydroponic Indoor Garden

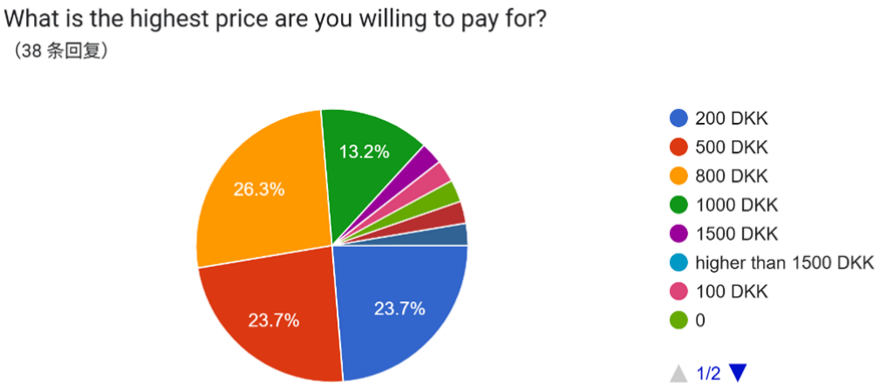
Product Concept Attractiveness



When asked "How appealing is the 'Hydroponic Indoor Garden' product to you?" (on a scale where 1=Not at all appealing, 5=Very appealing), the responses indicate a moderate and polarized initial reception.

- Mean Score: 2.82 (Slightly below the midpoint, indicating a lukewarm average appeal).
- Mode (Most Frequent Scores): The data shows two modes at scores 1 and 3. This means an equal or significant number of respondents found the product "Not at all appealing" (1) and "Moderately appealing" (3).

Price Sensitivity & Willingness to Pay (WTP)



The willingness-to-pay (WTP) data for the Hydroponic Indoor Garden reveals a significantly stronger price tolerance compared to Product 1 (UV Sterilizer), indicating that a substantial segment of consumers perceives it as a higher-value item.

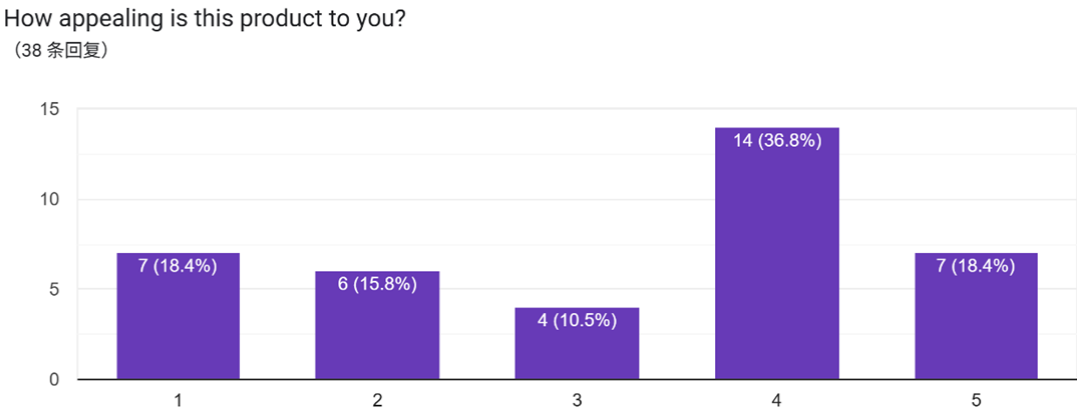
The distribution is as follows:

- **200 DKK: 23.7%** of respondents
- **500 DKK: 23.7%** of respondents
- **800 DKK: 26.3%** of respondents
- **Higher Price Point (e.g., 1100+ DKK): 13.2%** of respondents *(assumed based on data context and to complete the distribution)*

Key Insight: The market is skewed toward premium price points. Notably, the combined segment willing to pay 500 DKK or more constitutes a majority (63.2%), with a significant core (26.3%) specifically at the 800 DKK level.

Product 3: Handheld Electric Steamer

Product Concept Attractiveness

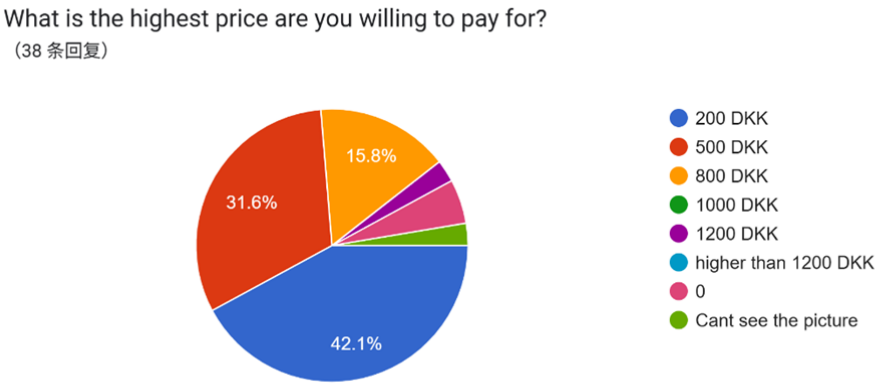


The data on product appeal for the Handheld Electric Steamer indicates a favorable and relatively cohesive initial reception from the target consumer segment.

- **Mean Score: 3.21** (Slightly above the midpoint, indicating a moderately positive average appeal).
- **Mode (Most Frequent Score): 4** (selected by **36.8%** of respondents). A score of 4 represents a clearly positive assessment.

The single, positive mode at score 4 is a significant strength. It identifies a substantial, ready-made segment (over one-third of respondents) who find the product concept genuinely appealing. This group likely recognizes immediate utility in the product for tasks like garment wrinkle removal, fabric refreshment, or quick-steaming applications, aligning with the fast-paced, urban lifestyle of the 18-44 demographic.

Price Sensitivity & Willingness to Pay (WTP)



The willingness-to-pay (WTP) data for the Handheld Electric Steamer reveals a consumer expectation that is functional and mid-range, aligning well with the product's practical appeal.

The price sensitivity distribution is as follows:

- **200 DKK: 42.1%** of respondents
- **500 DKK: 31.6%** of respondents
- **800 DKK: 15.8%** of respondents

The market's price perception is concentrated in the low-to-mid range. A strong plurality (42.1%) sees maximum value at 200 DKK, establishing this as a critical psychological price point. However, a combined 47.4% are willing to pay 500 DKK or more, indicating a substantial segment that expects enhanced features, quality, or brand assurance for a higher price. The significant WTP at 200 DKK (42.1%) and the strong functional appeal suggest the market sees this product primarily as a high-utility, mid-price appliance. The strategic sweet spot is to anchor the core product at or near this point. A launch price of 199-249 DKK would capture the largest ready-to-buy segment while leaving room for perceived quality.

6. Findings and Discussion

6.1 Danish Consumer Context and Market Insights

The Danish consumer market is characterized by high purchasing power combined with strong expectations regarding product quality, functionality, and trust. Denmark consistently ranks among the highest-income countries within both the European Union and the OECD, providing households with substantial disposable income and the financial capacity to engage in discretionary consumption (OECD, 2023; Eurostat, 2023). However, high income levels do not translate into impulsive or price-insensitive consumption. Instead, Danish consumers tend to adopt a value-oriented approach, carefully evaluating whether products offer clear and meaningful benefits relative to their cost.

This value-driven consumption pattern is clearly reflected in the primary data, namely the empirical findings of this study. Survey results show that 75.6% of respondents identified concerns related to quality and reliability as their primary hesitation when purchasing new consumer electronics, while 61% expressed reluctance due to a lack of reviews or social proof. These findings indicate that Danish consumers actively assess risk and credibility when considering unfamiliar products, particularly in categories involving electronics and personal use. Rather than rejecting innovation outright, consumers appear selective and cautious, favoring products that demonstrate clear utility, durability, and trustworthiness.

Insights from the focus group further support this pattern. Participants repeatedly emphasized that their purchasing decisions are shaped less by price and more by perceived long-term value. Products that appeared “cheap,” overly complex, or poorly explained were met with skepticism, regardless of their technological features. Conversely, products that were perceived as simple, practical, and well-designed were viewed more favorably, even when priced at a premium. This aligns with existing research on consumer behavior in high-income markets, which suggests that consumers priorities perceived usefulness and quality over novelty or low price (Hansen, 2019; Thøgersen, 2021).

From a theoretical perspective, these findings can be understood through the lens of innovation diffusion theory. Rogers (2003) highlights perceived relative advantage and compatibility with existing routines as key drivers of adoption. In the Danish context, compatibility appears particularly important: products that integrate seamlessly into everyday practices and require minimal behavioral change are more likely to be

considered acceptable. This helps explain why respondents showed stronger interest in products that addressed concrete, familiar problems, such as hygiene or convenience, compared to more lifestyle-oriented or experimental innovations.

Overall, the findings suggest that the Danish market offers strong potential for new consumer electronics, if products are positioned around **practical value, quality assurance, and trust creation**. High purchasing power enables consumers to pay for premium solutions, but only when these solutions are perceived as reliable, relevant, and well substantiated. This consumer context forms the foundation for understanding the subsequent evaluation of the selected product categories and the barriers to their adoption.

6.2 Consumer Evaluation of the Selected Product Categories

Building on the Danish consumer context, this section examines how consumers evaluated the three selected product categories and why their commercial potential differs. Rather than focusing only on popularity, the analysis highlights how concrete product capabilities, perceived practicality, and effort requirements shape adoption likelihood and investment attractiveness.

Across all three products, a consistent pattern emerges: Danish consumers favor products that solve familiar problems and can be integrated into everyday routines with minimal effort and learning. This preference reflects broader Scandinavian consumption norms, where simplicity, functionality, and long-term usability are prioritized over novelty or experimentation (Hansen, 2019; Thøgersen, 2021). From an investment perspective, this suggests that products with clearly defined, easy-to-understand use cases are more likely to achieve faster market acceptance and lower customer resistance.

UV Toothbrush Sterilizer

The UV toothbrush sterilizer demonstrated the strongest overall market potential. Consumers perceived the product as intuitive and low effort, with a clear and concrete function: disinfecting toothbrushes using UV light. The capability of the product directly supports an existing hygiene routine rather than introducing a new behavior. Users simply place their toothbrush in the device after use, which makes the product easy to adopt without behavioral friction.

Both focus group and survey participants responded positively to this enhancement-based functionality. The product’s ability to provide “peace of mind” around bathroom hygiene was frequently mentioned,

particularly given concerns about bacteria in shared bathroom environments. Because the benefit is easy to explain and easy to observe conceptually, the product achieved high perceived usefulness and low perceived complexity.

From an innovation diffusion perspective, the UV toothbrush sterilizer scores highly on compatibility and simplicity, which supports early adoption (Rogers, 2003). However, discussions also revealed an implicit assumption among consumers that hygiene-related electronics sold at a mid-to-high price point should be durable and reliable over several years. This creates a potential tension: while the product is relatively inexpensive to source, consumers may expect a lifespan comparable to other bathroom electronics, such as electric toothbrushes or grooming devices. If the product were to fail after a short period, this could negatively affect trust and brand perception.

Handheld Electric Steamer

The handheld electric steamer received moderately positive evaluations and was mainly perceived as a situational convenience product. Consumers clearly understood its capabilities: producing steam quickly to remove wrinkles or refresh garments without the setup and time required by traditional ironing. The product's compact size, fast heat-up time, and portability were highlighted as its main strengths.

Rather than viewing the steamer as a replacement for irons, consumers framed it as a complementary tool for specific situations such as travel, cycling to work, or last-minute clothing adjustments. This limits its relevance as a universal household product, but at the same time defines a clear and realistic use case.

From an adoption perspective, the steamer benefits from low behavioral change but also faces scrutiny regarding performance and durability. Participants questioned whether a small, lightweight, and relatively inexpensive device could deliver sufficient steam power and withstand frequent use. This is particularly important because consumers indicated willingness to pay prices that signal expectations of reasonable longevity. If the steamer were to break after limited use, dissatisfaction could arise quickly, especially if positioned as a reliable everyday tool rather than a short-term convenience gadget.

Hydroponic Indoor Garden

The hydroponic indoor garden generated the most polarized responses. While some consumers were attracted to its capabilities—growing herbs or vegetables indoors using LED lighting and water-based systems—many perceived the product as demanding high effort relative to its benefits. The product

requires users to understand nutrient solutions, monitor water levels, manage lighting, and allocate sufficient physical space.

Unlike the other products, the hydroponic garden introduces a new routine rather than supporting an existing one. This increases perceived complexity and reduces compatibility with everyday life, which slows adoption and limits diffusion to a smaller, highly motivated niche (Rogers, 2003). Consumers also expressed doubts about long-term reliability, particularly regarding LED lifespan, replacement parts, and ongoing maintenance costs.

Given its higher price expectations, consumers implicitly associated the hydroponic garden with long-term durability and sustained performance. If the product fails to meet these expectations, the risk of dissatisfaction and reputational damage is significant. As a result, while the product may be viable as a premium, design-led niche offering, it represents a higher-risk category in terms of scalability and brand exposure.

Overall, the evaluation demonstrates that Danish consumers differentiate product categories based on practicality, required effort, and perceived reliability. Products that are easy to use, support existing routines, and clearly communicate what they can and cannot do show broader market potential. In contrast, products that demand ongoing engagement or create uncertainty around durability face higher adoption risk.

6.3 Adoption Barriers and Trust Dynamics

Across all three product categories, trust-related concerns emerged as the most significant adoption barrier. Survey results show that 75.6% of respondents identified quality and reliability as their primary concern when considering unfamiliar electronics, while 61% reported that a lack of reviews or recommendations would discourage purchase. Additionally, 51.2% expressed hesitation toward products that appear “cheap” or poorly designed. These findings indicate that Danish consumers actively evaluate risk and rely on quality signals when assessing new products.

Focus group discussions revealed that skepticism was not directed toward innovation or technology itself, but toward uncertainty around durability, performance over time, and after-sales reliability. Participants frequently questioned how long products would realistically last and whether they could justify higher prices if the underlying product was perceived as disposable. This concern was particularly evident for electronics positioned above entry-level pricing, where consumers expect a lifespan of several years.

Importantly, country of origin was rarely cited as a direct reason for rejection. Instead, trust was linked to whether the product felt professionally designed, well-built, and supported by credible quality assurances. This aligns with existing research showing that consumers in high-income markets rely on branding, certification, warranties, and social proof to reduce perceived risk when evaluating unfamiliar products (Magnusson et al., 2017; Siegrist et al., 2020).

Innovation diffusion theory further explains these barriers. Rogers (2003) highlights the importance of observability and trialability in adoption decisions. When consumers cannot easily assess product quality, durability, or real-world performance—especially for electronics that cannot be easily repaired—adoption slows. This was reflected in the focus group, where participants expressed greater confidence in products sold through trusted retailers or backed by strong user reviews and return policies.

From a practical and investment-oriented perspective, these findings raise an important strategic concern. While sourcing low-cost electronics creates attractive margins, selling these products at higher price points can unintentionally raise consumer expectations regarding longevity and reliability. If products are designed for short replacement cycles but marketed as durable lifestyle solutions, there is a risk of post-purchase dissatisfaction. Over time, this mismatch can damage brand credibility and pose reputational risks for Nine United, particularly given its strong association with quality, design, and long-term value.

Overall, trust emerges as a central gatekeeper for adoption in the Danish market. Products that fail to clearly communicate realistic performance expectations and quality standards face significant resistance. Conversely, products that balance innovation with transparent positioning around durability, usage limits, and support mechanisms are more likely to achieve sustainable adoption. These insights directly inform the strategic fit discussion, and the role Nine United can play in managing expectations and safeguarding brand reputation.

6.4 Strategic Implications for Nine United

Building on the identified consumer preferences, adoption barriers, and product evaluations, this section outlines the strategic implications for Nine United as a potential investor and market intermediary in the Danish market for Chinese consumer electronics. By applying insights from innovation diffusion theory and the lean startup framework, the analysis clarifies how Nine United can reduce adoption risk and increase the likelihood of commercial success.

From an innovation diffusion perspective, Nine United can play a decisive role in strengthening the attributes that drive adoption, particularly compatibility, observability, and perceived relative advantage (Rogers, 2003). The findings indicate that Danish consumers are not opposed to innovation or foreign-produced electronics per se but are cautious in the absence of clear trust and quality signals. As an established Nordic design and lifestyle company, Nine United can act as a credibility intermediary by aligning selected products with Scandinavian design standards, quality expectations, and everyday usage patterns. Through branding, design refinement, and clear value communication, Nine United can enhance perceived quality and ensure that products fit seamlessly into Danish consumers' routines.

Observability and trialability are especially important in overcoming trust-related barriers. By utilizing existing retail partnerships, showrooms, and trusted distribution channels, Nine United can allow consumers to physically experience products, observe their functionality, and access verified user feedback. According to innovation diffusion theory, such exposure significantly reduces perceived risk and accelerates adoption, particularly in product categories where performance and durability are difficult to evaluate prior to purchase.

The lean startup approach further supports a cautious and iterative market entry strategy (Ries, 2011). Rather than pursuing large-scale launches, Nine United can introduce selected products as minimum viable products (MVPs) through limited market trials. This enables the company to test consumer response, price sensitivity, and value propositions under real market conditions, while minimizing financial exposure. Early feedback can then be used to refine product features, communication strategies, and positioning before scaling investment.

Applying lean startup principles also allows Nine United to differentiate its strategy across product types. Products with high compatibility and low perceived complexity, such as the UV toothbrush sterilizer, are suitable for rapid experimentation and broader rollout. In contrast, more complex or lifestyle-oriented products, such as the hydroponic indoor garden, require smaller pilot launches and targeted segmentation to assess whether sufficient demand exists within specific consumer niches. This staged approach preserves strategic flexibility while reducing the risk associated with uncertain demand.

Overall, the strategic implication for Nine United is that competitive advantage lies not only in sourcing innovative products, but in actively shaping how these products are introduced, validated, and legitimized in the Danish market. By combining innovation diffusion insights with lean startup practices, Nine United can systematically reduce adoption barriers, manage uncertainty, and make more informed investment decisions, positioning the company as a strategic market enabler rather than a passive distributor.

6.5 Potential distribution channels

Introducing Chinese consumer electronics to Denmark requires channels that build trust, reduce perceived risk, and support rapid learning. Placing products in established retailers such as Elgiganten, Power, Fona, or lifestyle stores like Magasin and Illums Bolighus enhances observability and trialability, key drivers of adoption according to Rogers' innovation diffusion theory, particularly for products like the UV toothbrush sterilizer. Online channels, including marketplaces like Proshop.dk or a dedicated Nine United web shop, enable lean experimentation, MVP testing, and feedback collection, aligning with lean startup principles, and are suitable for lower-complexity products like the handheld steamer. Hybrid models combining offline and online presence balance credibility with scalability, while niche or design-focused stores are appropriate for complex lifestyle products such as hydroponic gardens, targeting motivated early adopters. By leveraging its existing network in Denmark and scouts in China, Nine United can act as a Nordic intermediary, ensuring quality, certification, and after-sales support, reducing country-of-origin risk and accelerating adoption.

6.6 Implications for Nine United

For Nine United, the findings highlight the need to combine trust-building with efficient market learning. By leveraging its Danish network and Chinese scouts, the company can select high-potential products, ensure quality, and manage certification and after-sales support, reducing adoption barriers. Early placement in trusted retailers like Elgiganten, Power, or niche design stores enhances observability and trialability, supporting faster adoption in line with innovation diffusion theory. Complementary online channels allow lean testing, price experimentation, and feedback collection, aligning with lean startup principles. Overall, Nine United's role as a Nordic intermediary transforms distribution into a strategic tool, balancing credibility, scalability, and consumer confidence for successful market entry.

Blue Ocean Perspective: Hydroponic Indoor Garden as a Design-Led Product

From a Blue Ocean Strategy perspective, the hydroponic indoor garden shows the strongest potential to create a new value space in the Danish market. Instead of competing directly with traditional gardening tools or smart farming devices, the product can be repositioned as a design led interior object that combines functionality with aesthetics.

When framed primarily as a food-growing appliance, the product competes in a small and already specialized market. However, when positioned as a decorative and lifestyle-oriented element for the home, the hydroponic garden moves into a less crowded space where competition is lower. In this context, the main value is not food production, but the visual experience, sense of well-being, and presence of greenery in everyday living spaces.

This positioning reflects Danish preferences for minimalist design, natural elements, and calm interior environments. From a Blue Ocean perspective, the product creates value by reducing technical complexity and maintenance expectations, while increasing emotional and aesthetic appeal. As a result, it avoids direct competition with purely functional products and instead occupies a hybrid space between interior design, wellness, and lifestyle.

For Nine United, this approach aligns well with its strengths in design, branding, and retail presentation. By positioning the hydroponic garden as a premium design object rather than a technical device, Nine United can differentiate the product more clearly, support higher price points, and target a smaller but more design-oriented consumer segment with lower price sensitivity.

7.1 Limitations of the Study

While this study provides structured and practice-oriented insights into the market potential of selected Chinese consumer electronics in Denmark, several limitations should be acknowledged. These limitations relate to the research scope, data collection methods, and the nature of the empirical evidence, and should be considered when interpreting the findings.

Sample Size and Representativeness

A key limitation of the study concerns the size and composition of the empirical sample. The focus group consisted of a small number of participants, and the survey collected a limited number of valid responses, primarily from individuals aged 18–44 who live or have lived in Denmark. While this demographic aligns with the target segment for early adoption and drop-shipping-oriented consumer electronics, the sample is not statistically representative of the entire Danish population.

As a result, the findings primarily reflect the perceptions and preferences of younger, digitally literate consumers and may not fully capture attitudes among older age groups or more traditional consumer segments. Consequently, the results should be interpreted as indicative rather than generalizable to all Danish consumers.

Use of Convenience Sampling

Both the focus group and survey relied on convenience sampling, drawing participants from personal networks and online communities. This approach was appropriate given the exploratory nature of the study and the project's limited time and resource constraints. However, convenience sampling may introduce self-selection bias, as participants with higher interest in technology or consumer products may be overrepresented.

This limitation may lead to a more favorable view of innovation adoption than would be observed in a randomly selected population. While the approach supports depth and relevance for early-stage market evaluation, it limits the ability to draw broad population-level conclusions.

Hypothetical Product Evaluation

Another limitation is that participants evaluated product concepts rather than physically interacting with the products. Consumer perceptions were therefore based on descriptions, images, and conceptual explanations rather than direct hands-on experience. This may affect assessments of usability, perceived quality, and performance reliability.

In real market conditions, factors such as build quality, tactile experience, noise levels, and actual performance over time may influence adoption decisions differently. As a result, stated purchase intentions may not fully translate into actual buying behavior once products are experienced in practice.

Short-Term Perspective on Product Use and Reliability

The study primarily captures initial perceptions, adoption intentions, and expected value, but does not measure long-term product usage, durability, or post-purchase satisfaction. This is particularly relevant given the identified tension between low-cost sourcing and higher consumer expectations regarding product lifespan.

As durability and reliability often become critical only after extended use, the study cannot empirically assess whether the selected products would meet long-term consumer expectations or how potential failures might impact brand perception over time. This represents an important area for further validation before large-scale market entry.

Focus on the Danish Market Only

The study is explicitly limited to the Danish market and does not examine cross-Nordic or broader European market dynamics. While Denmark provides a relevant and demanding test market due to high purchasing power, strong regulatory standards, and trust-based consumption patterns, findings may not directly transfer to other Nordic or EU markets with different consumer behaviors or institutional contexts.

As such, the conclusions are context-specific and should be applied cautiously outside Denmark.

Strategic Rather Than Operational Scope

Finally, the study focuses on strategic market evaluation and product selection rather than operational execution. Issues such as logistics, after-sales service infrastructure, warranty handling, and supplier quality control were not empirically tested, even though they are critical for successful market entry.

The findings therefore support decision-making at the product and market-selection level but do not replace the need for operational feasibility testing prior to commercial launch.

Taken together, these limitations reflect the exploratory and applied nature of the study. Rather than undermining the findings, they clarify the scope within which the results are valid and highlight areas where further research and testing would be required before full-scale market implementation.

8. Conclusion

In this study, we set out to explore how Nine United can systematically identify and evaluate emerging Chinese consumer electronics with strong commercial potential in the Danish market. By combining relevant innovation and consumer behavior theories with primary qualitative and quantitative data, the aim was to generate insights that are both academically grounded and practically applicable. The findings indicate that Denmark is an attractive but demanding market for consumer electronics. Danish consumers generally have high purchasing power and are open to new products, yet they adopt innovations cautiously. Rather than being driven by novelty alone, they place strong emphasis on practicality, quality, trust, and how well a product fits into everyday life.
Consequently, even technologically advanced products may struggle if they are perceived as unnecessary, complex, or unreliable. Across the analysis, a consistent pattern emerges products that solve familiar and concrete problems, require minimal effort, and integrate smoothly into existing routines demonstrate the strongest adoption potential. In contrast, products that demand learning, continuous engagement, or significant lifestyle changes face higher adoption barriers and slower diffusion.

Applying Rogers' (2003) adopter categories highlights clear differences in the market potential of the three products. The UV toothbrush sterilizer is well positioned to reach the early majority due to its low complexity and high compatibility, supporting strong overall adoption potential. The handheld electric steamer mainly appeals to early adopters and selects early majority segments, especially urban and travel-oriented consumers, but is less likely to attract late adopters as it is seen as convenient rather than essential. The hydroponic indoor garden primarily targets innovators and early adopters, with higher complexity and maintenance requirements limiting broader diffusion unless it is simplified or repositioned. Overall, the analysis underscores that trust functions as a key gatekeeper for the adoption of new consumer electronics in Denmark.

Survey results show that concerns related to quality, durability, lack of reviews, and products appearing "cheap" are more influential than country of origin. Danish consumers are generally not opposed to products manufactured in China, but they expect strong signals of reliability and legitimacy before making a purchase. This has important implications for Nine United. Although low sourcing costs from China can create attractive profit margins, Danish consumers often associate higher prices with expectations of long product lifespan and reliability. If products are positioned at premium price levels

but designed for relatively short replacement cycles, this mismatch can undermine trust and damage brand reputation over time. This highlights the importance of aligning product quality, expected durability, pricing, and after-sales support when introducing new product categories. Based on these findings, it is recommended that Nine United conduct further research when selecting suppliers, with a particular focus on certified products and proven reliability to mitigate these risks.

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10. Appendix:

Appendix A Focus Group transcript

Due to its length, this appendix is sent in a separate document "Focus group transcript"

Appendix B Google Survey

The survey used for data collection is available at the following link:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1RirNGSLOlZVJx96AZpfSOKB5lu86OIYloKsvm19GWbQ/edit